

# Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve

## SEACAR Water Quality Analysis

Last compiled on 05 May, 2026

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# Indicators

## Nutrients

### Total Nitrogen - Discrete

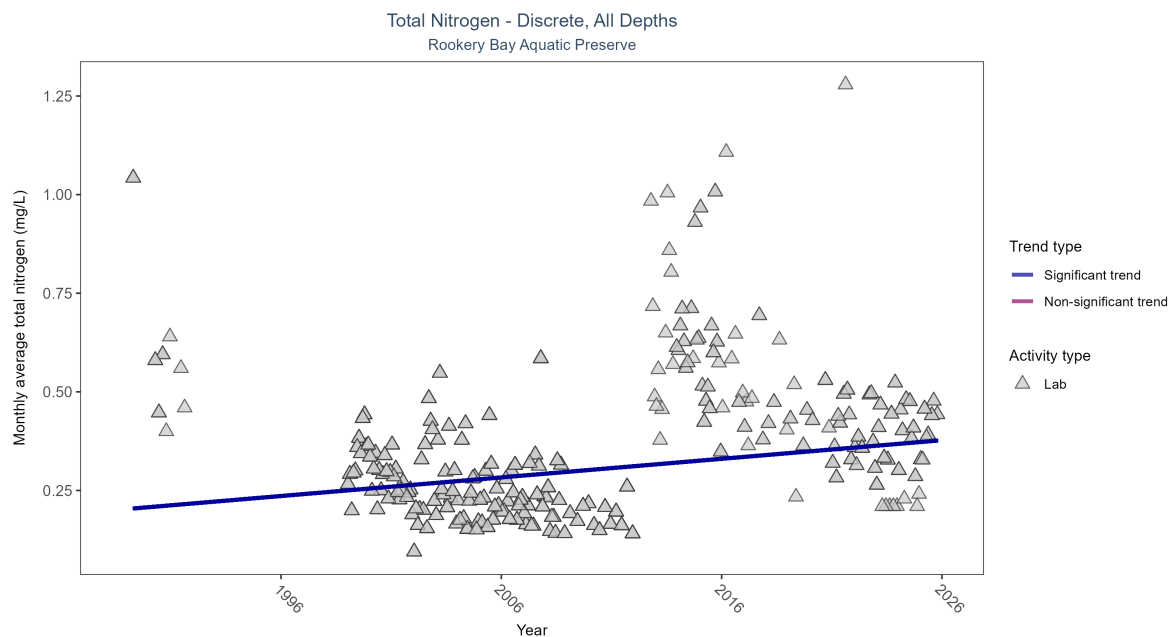


Figure 1: Scatter plot of monthly average total nitrogen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only nitrogen values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 1: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Total Nitrogen

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P     |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|-------|
| Lab           | Significantly increasing trend | 2640         | 30              | 1989 - 2025      | 0.26                | 0.1689 | 0.20291       | 0.00472   | 2e-04 |

Monthly average total nitrogen increased by less than 0.01 mg/L per year.

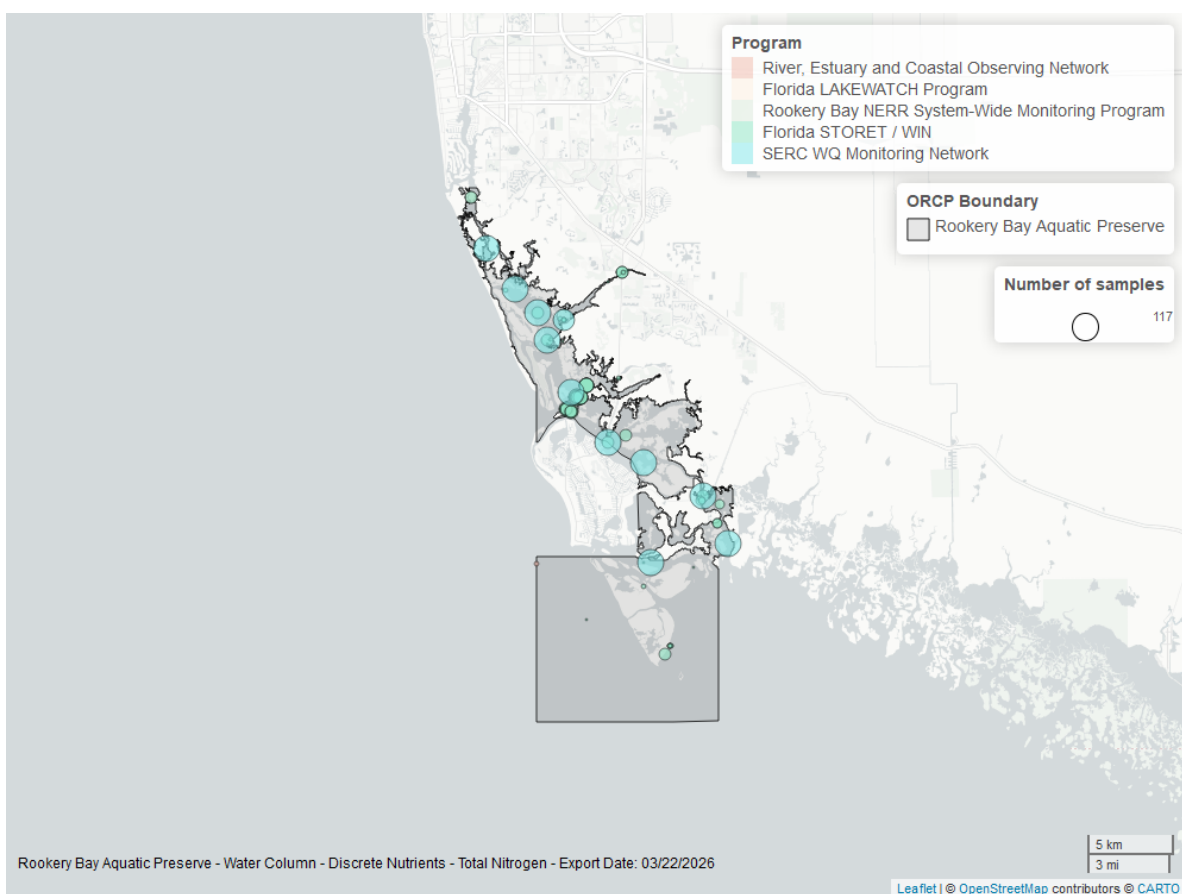


Figure 2: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Total Phosphorus - Discrete

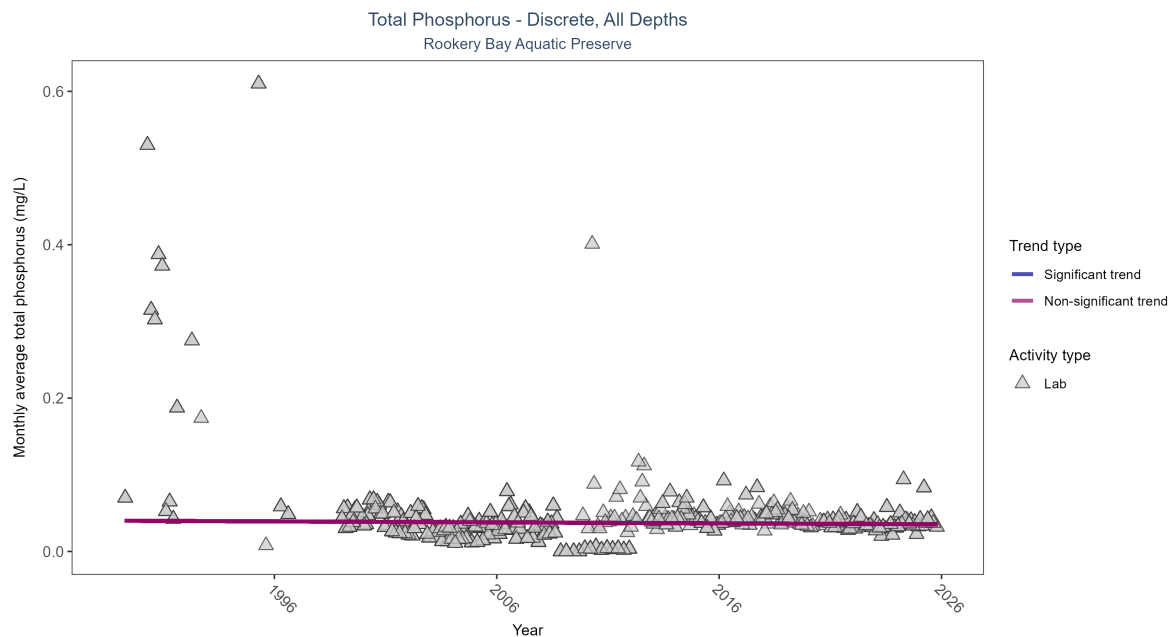


Figure 3: Scatter plot of monthly average total phosphorus over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only phosphorus values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 2: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Total Phosphorus

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau      | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|----------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | No significant trend | 2270         | 33              | 1989 - 2025      | 0.034               | -0.03641 | 0.04007       | -0.00013  | 0.2966 |

Total phosphorus showed no detectable trend between 1989 and 2025.

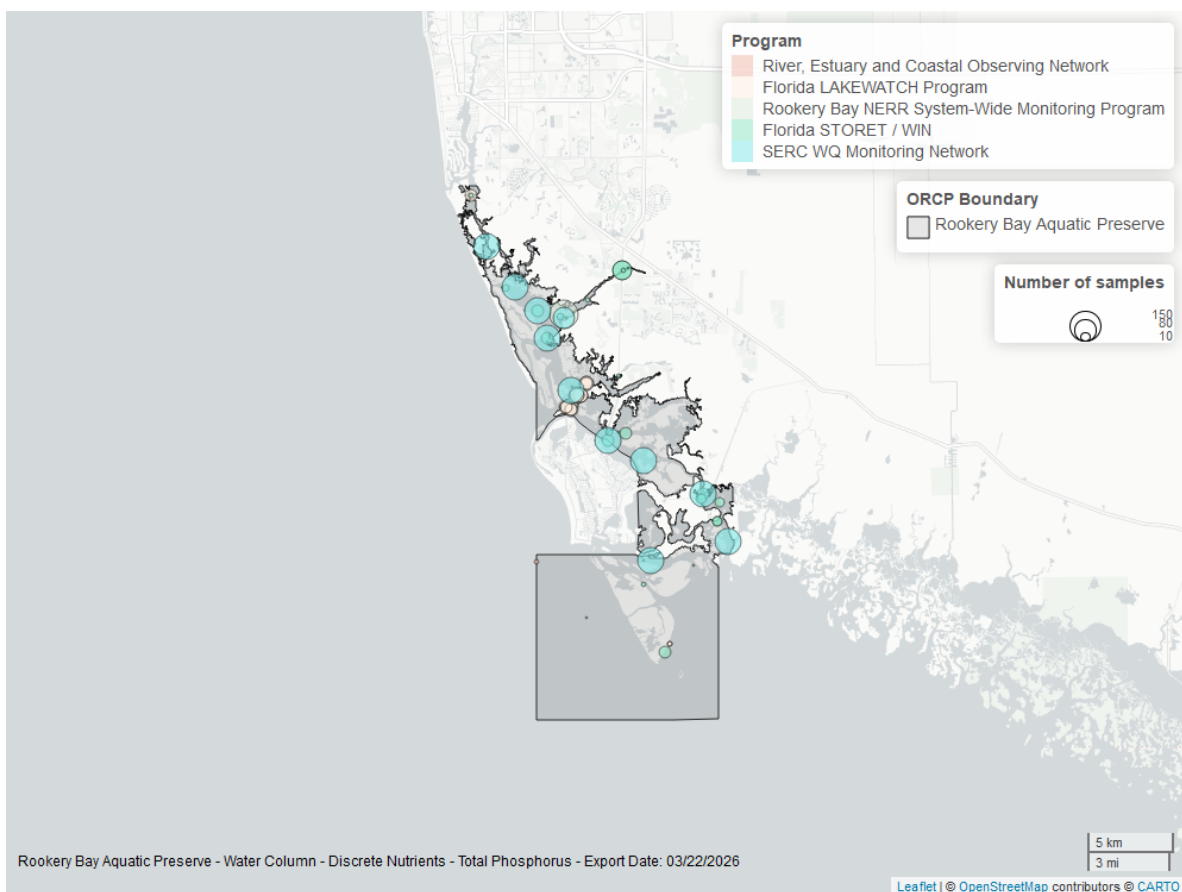


Figure 4: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Water Quality

### Dissolved Oxygen - Continuous

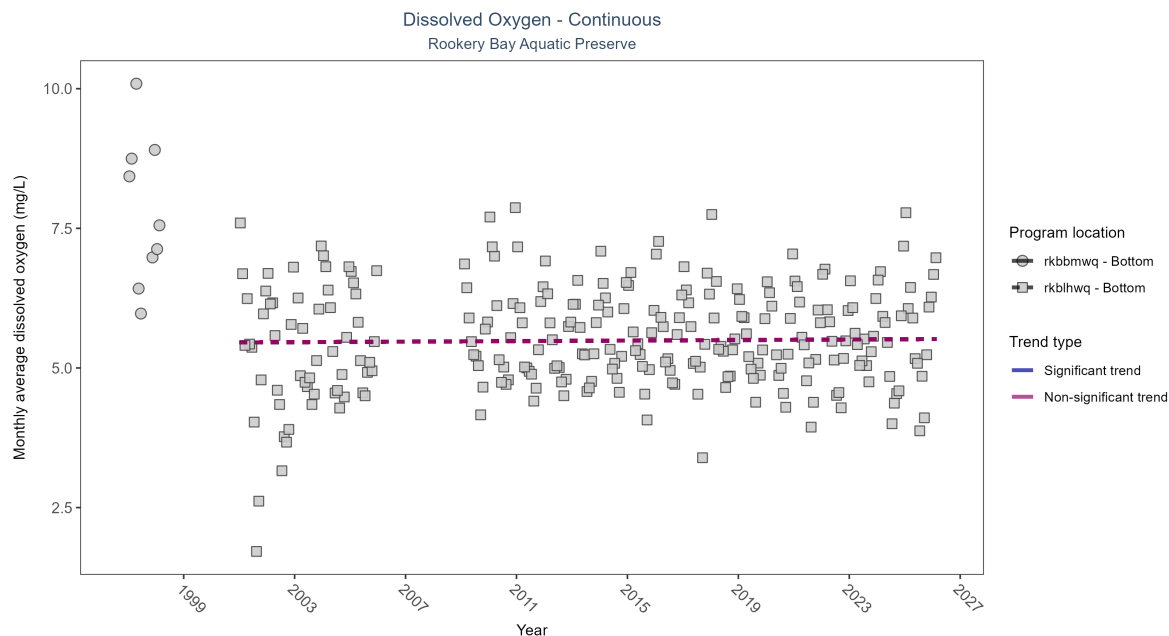


Figure 5: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 3: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Dissolved Oxygen

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 10441        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 7.2                 | -    | -             | -         | -      |
| rkblhwq          | No significant trend                 | 613216       | 23              | 2001 - 2026      | 5.6                 | 0.03 | 5.46          | 0         | 0.5182 |

No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen was observed at one location. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

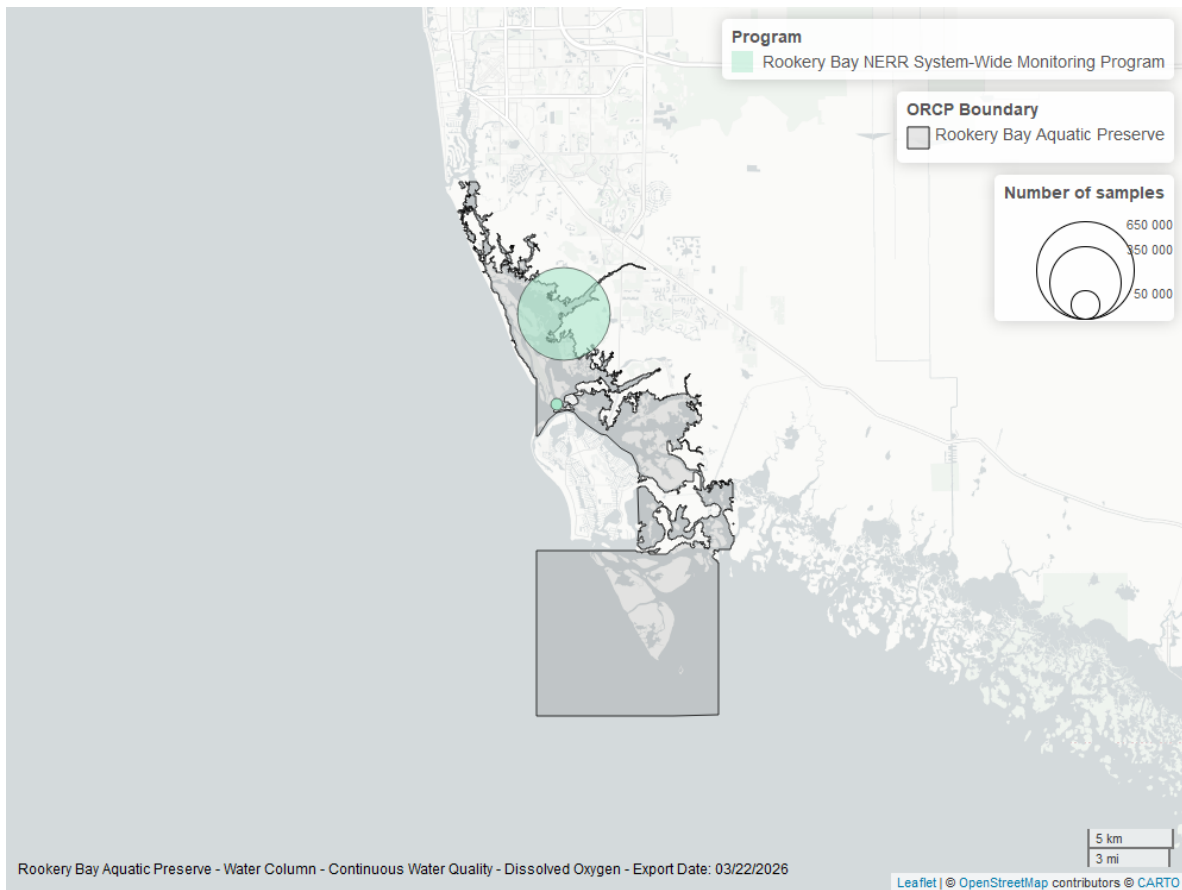


Figure 6: Map showing location of dissolved oxygen continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Dissolved Oxygen - Discrete

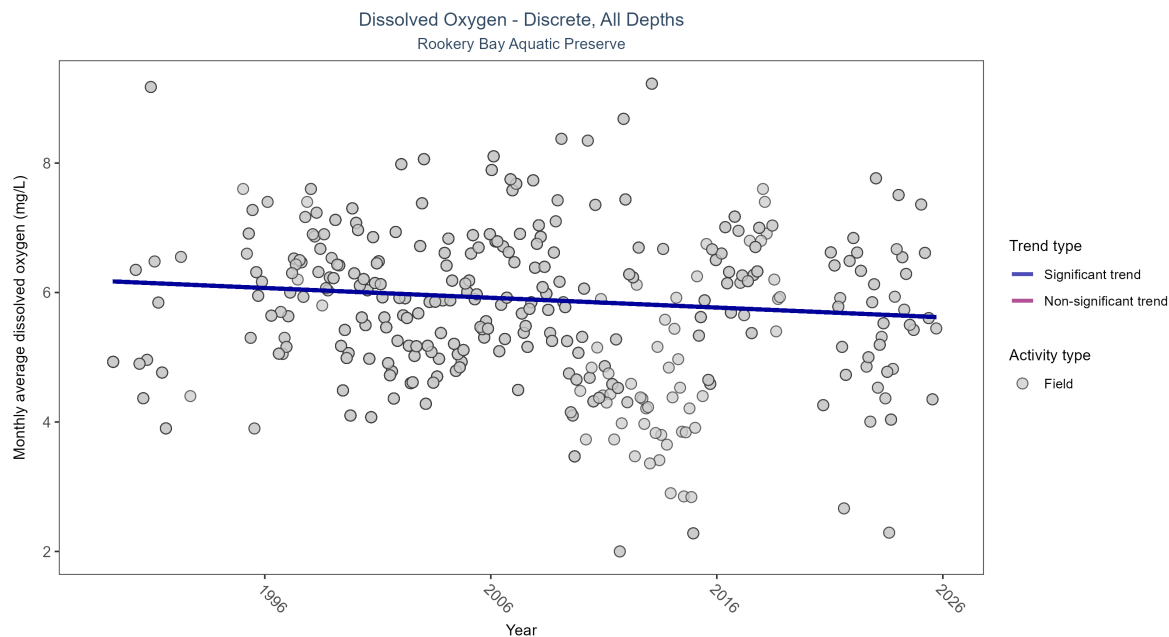


Figure 7: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 4: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Dissolved Oxygen

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau      | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|----------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | Significantly decreasing trend | 3909         | 34              | 1989 - 2025      | 5.9                 | -0.09659 | 6.17588       | -0.01511  | 0.0161 |

Monthly average dissolved oxygen decreased by 0.02 mg/L per year.



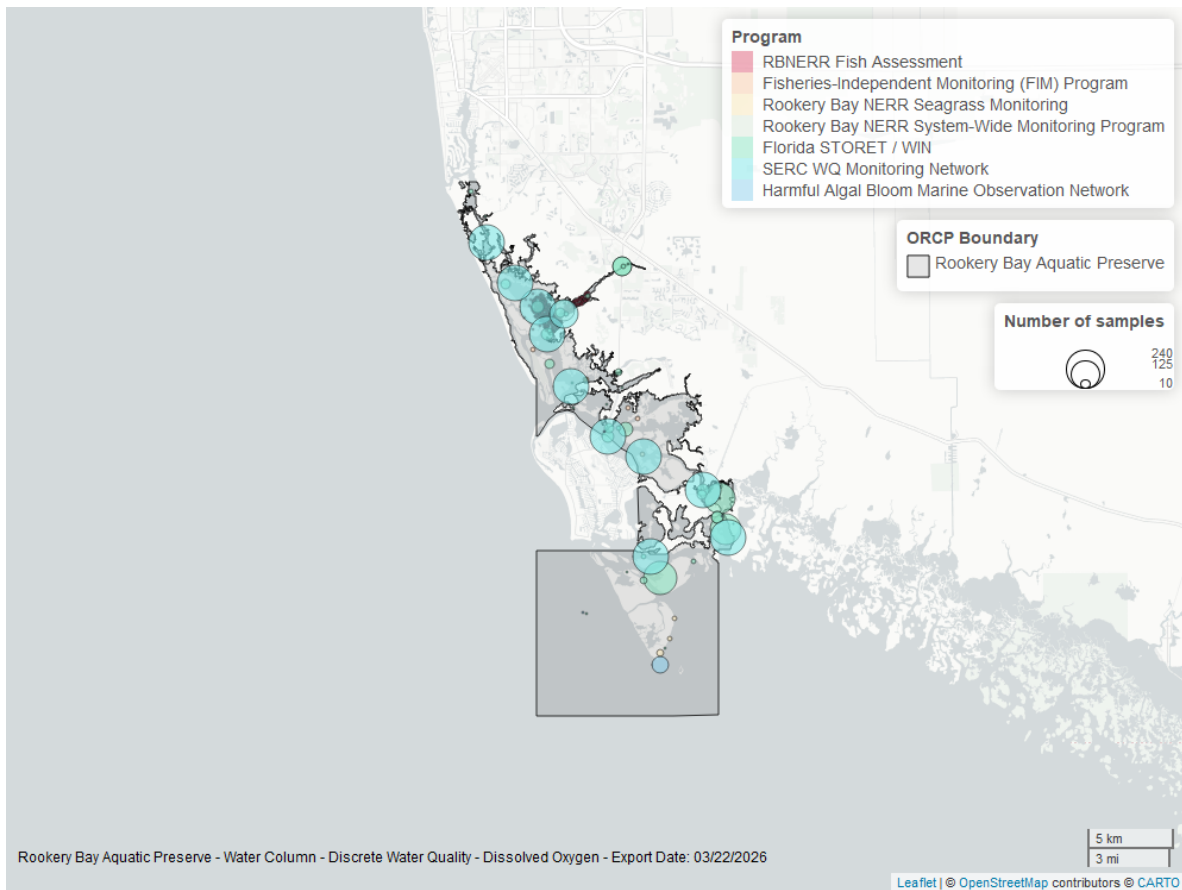


Figure 8: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Continuous

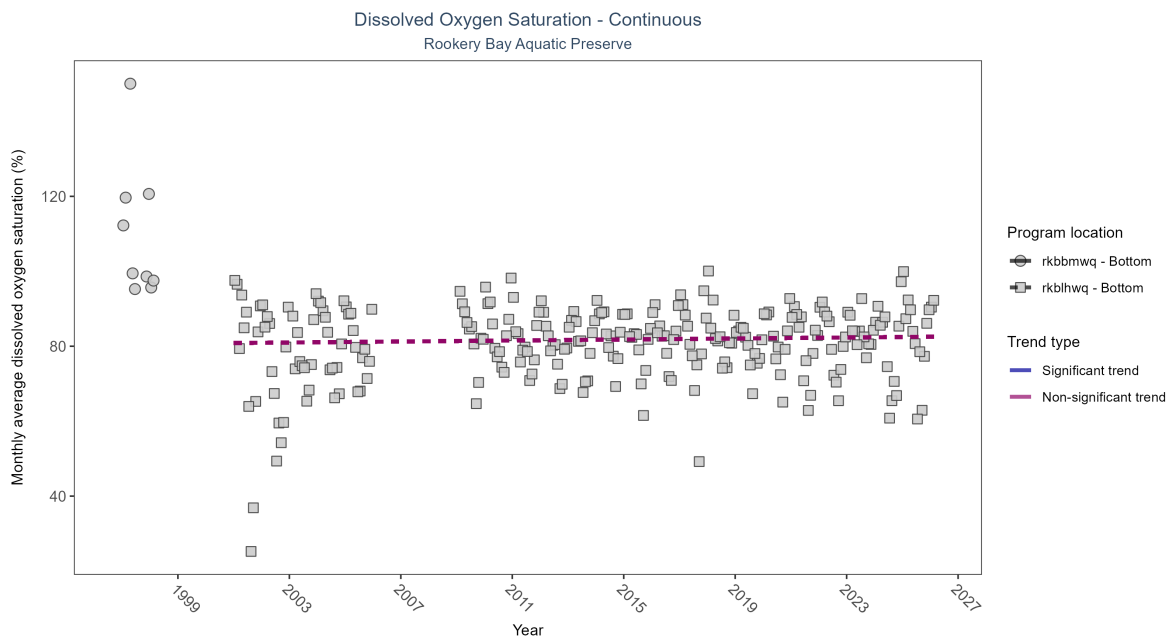


Figure 9: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 5: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 10441        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 102.4               | -    | -             | -         | -      |
| rkblhwq          | No significant trend                 | 625534       | 23              | 2001 - 2026      | 82.1                | 0.07 | 80.86         | 0.07      | 0.1302 |

No detectable change in monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation was observed at one location. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

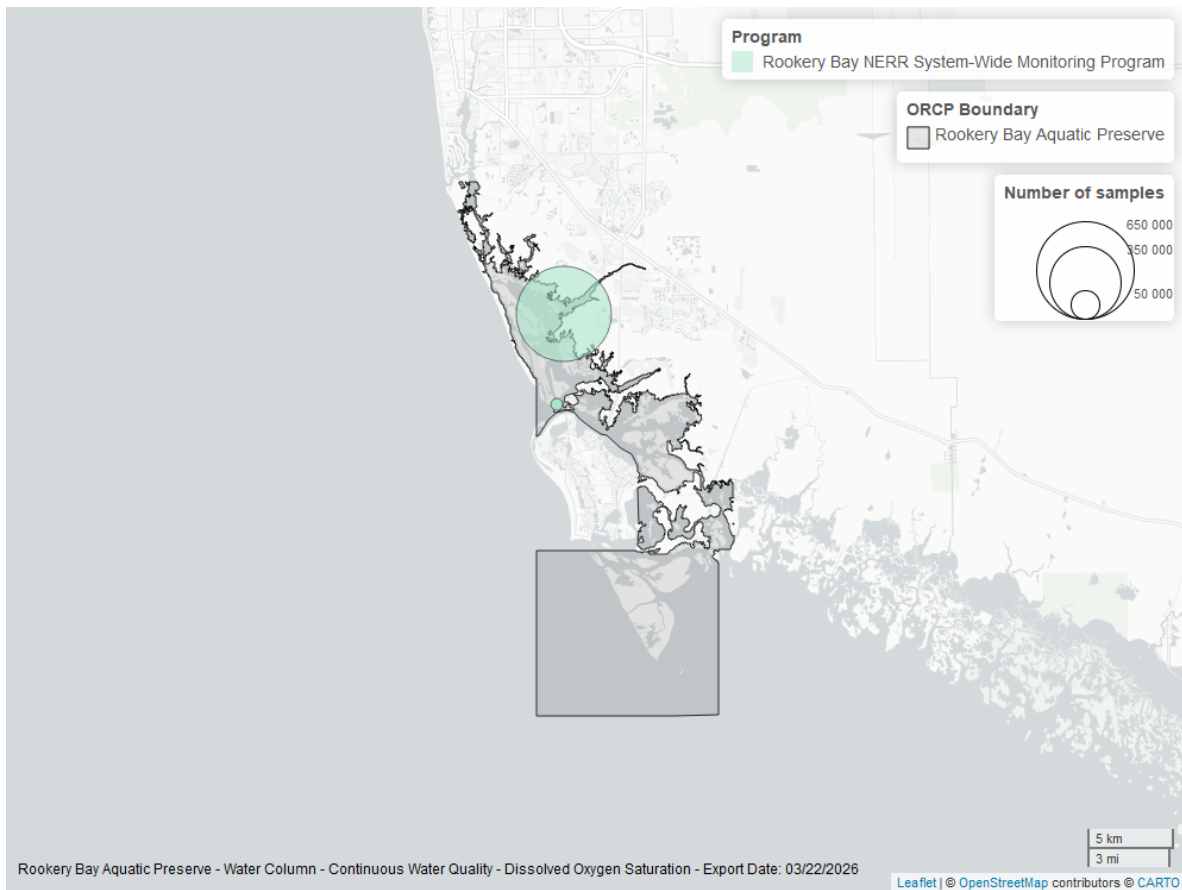


Figure 10: Map showing location of dissolved oxygen saturation continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Dissolved Oxygen Saturation - Discrete

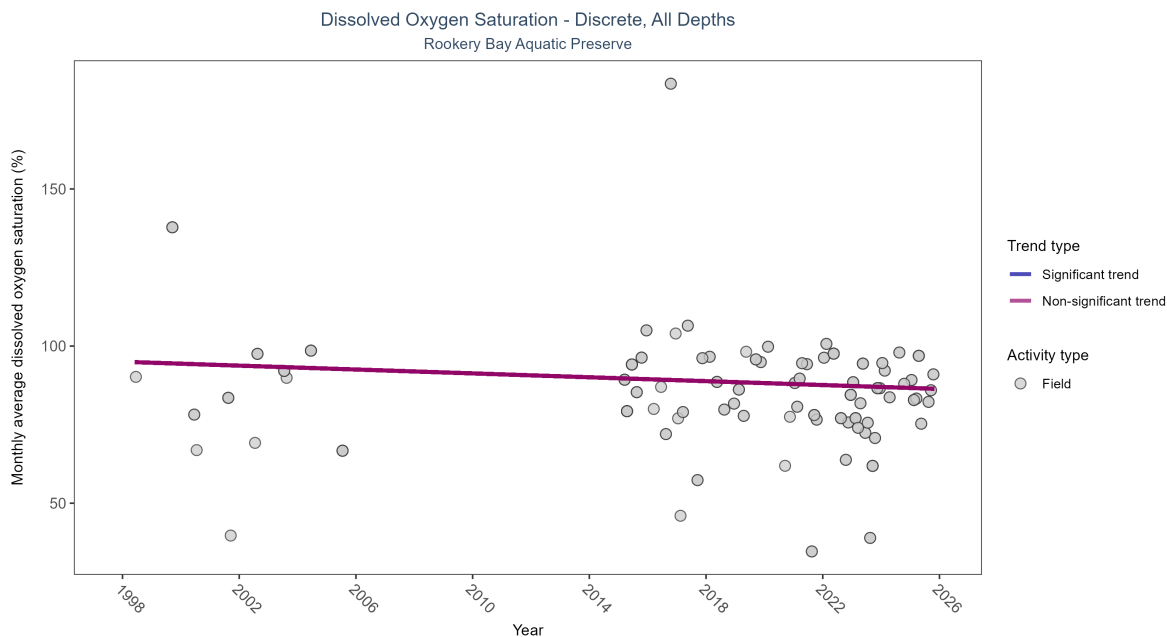


Figure 11: Scatter plot of monthly average dissolved oxygen saturation over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only dissolved oxygen saturation values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 6: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Dissolved Oxygen Saturation

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau      | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|----------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | No significant trend | 197          | 19              | 1998 - 2025      | 86.1                | -0.07319 | 95.01341      | -0.30873  | 0.4526 |

Dissolved oxygen saturation showed no detectable trend between 1998 and 2025.

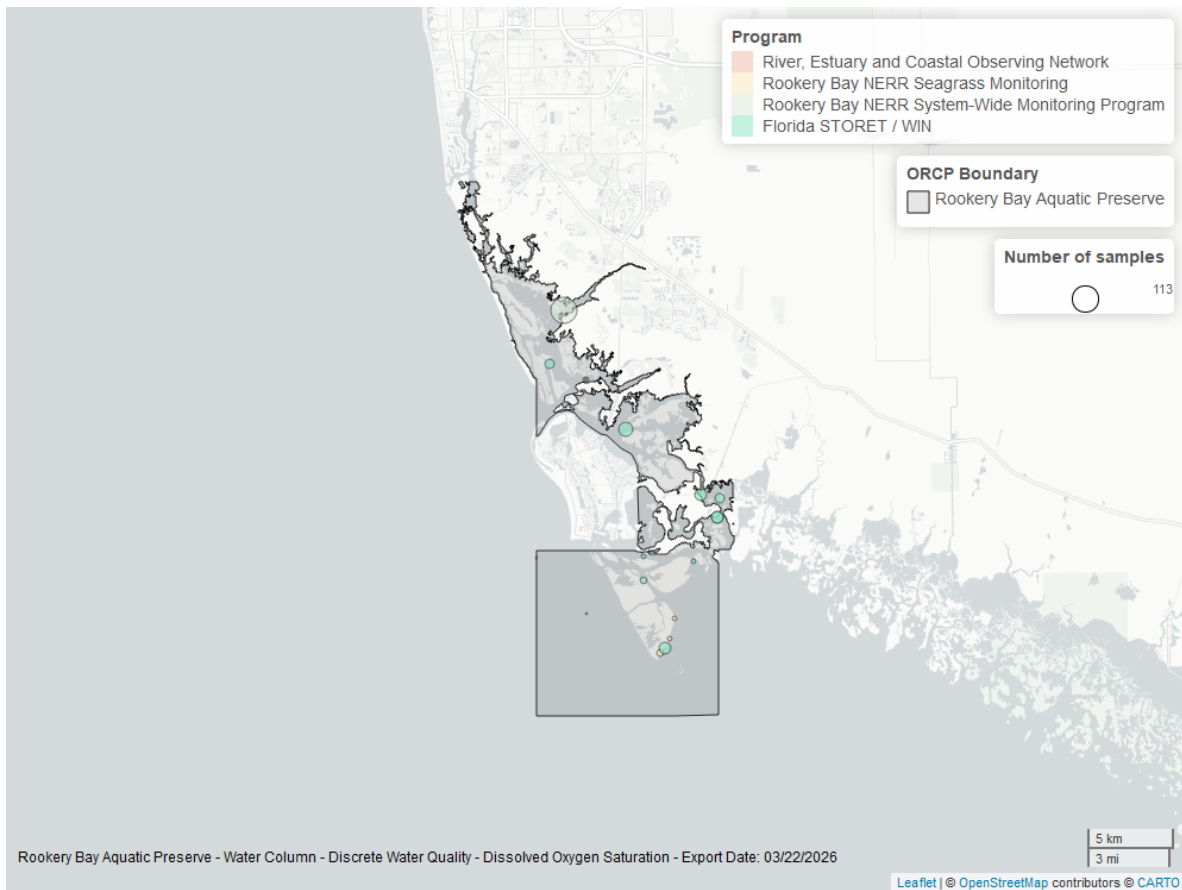


Figure 12: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Salinity - Discrete

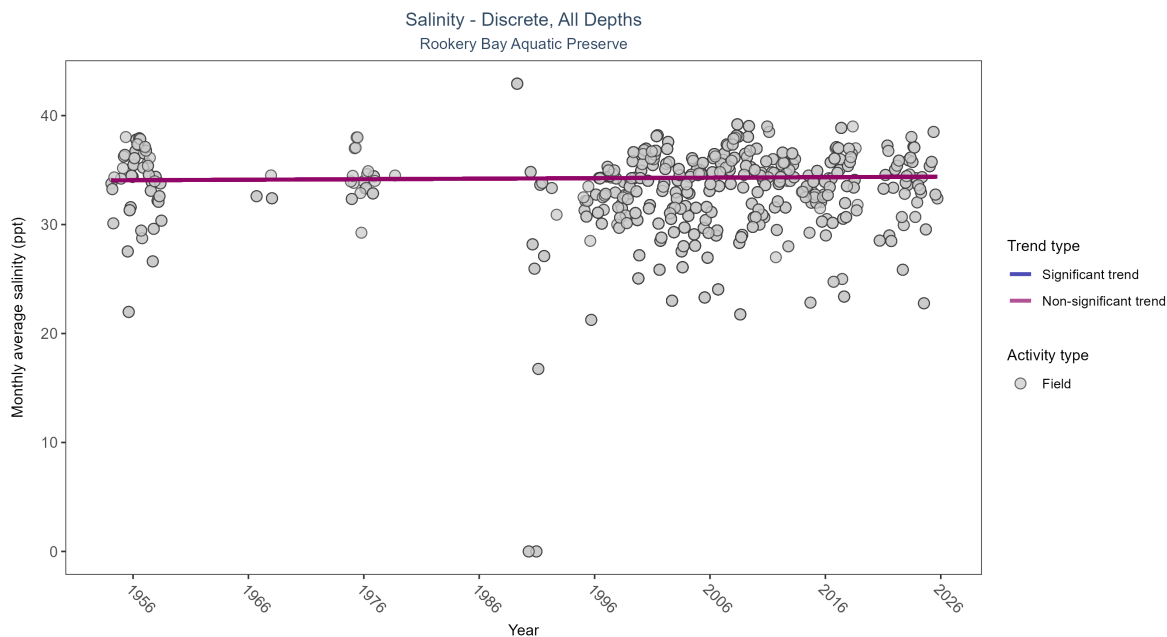


Figure 13: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines are also shown. Discrete salinity values derived from grab samples analyzed in the field (circles) or the laboratory (triangles) are both included in the plot.

Table 7: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Salinity

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| All           | No significant trend | 5327         | 46              | 1954 - 2025      | 34.14               | 0.02259 | 34.05806      | 0.00467   | 0.5218 |

Salinity showed no detectable trend between 1954 and 2025.

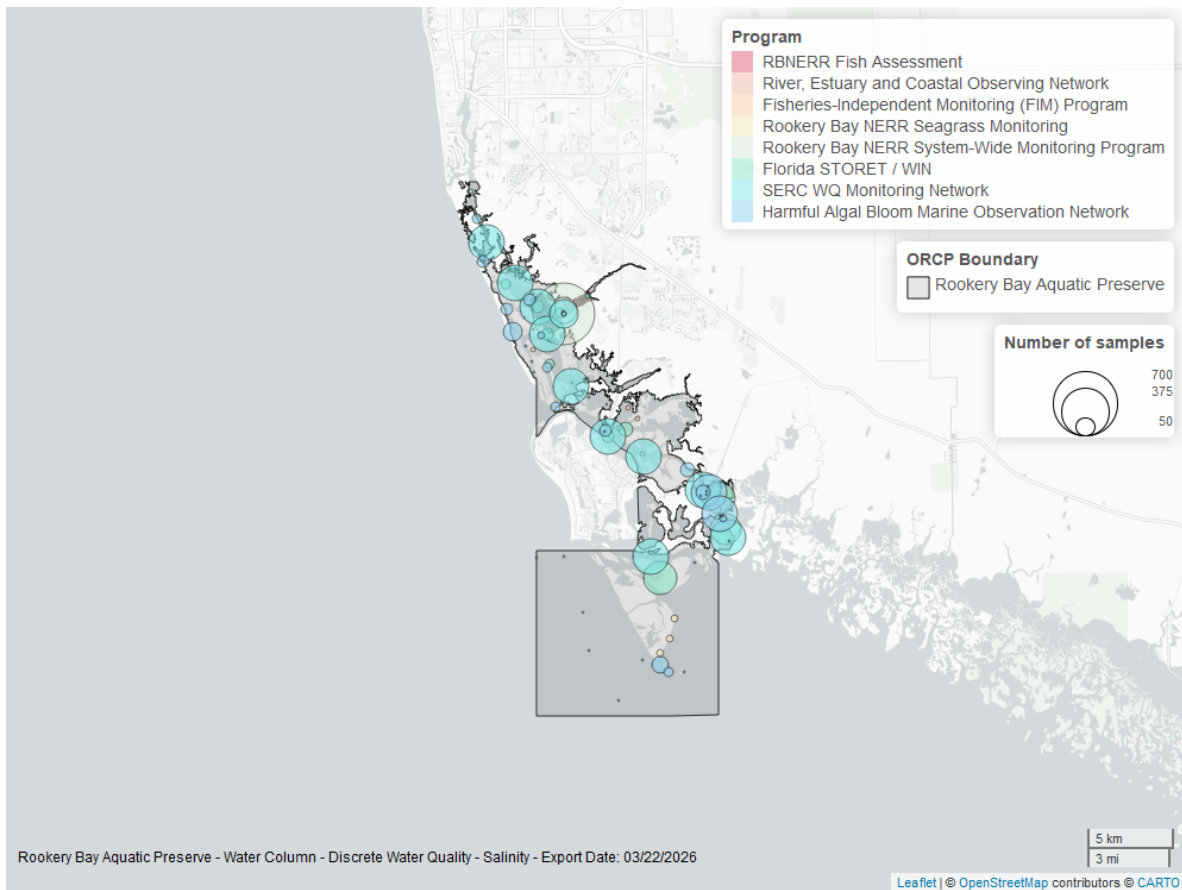


Figure 14: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Salinity - Continuous

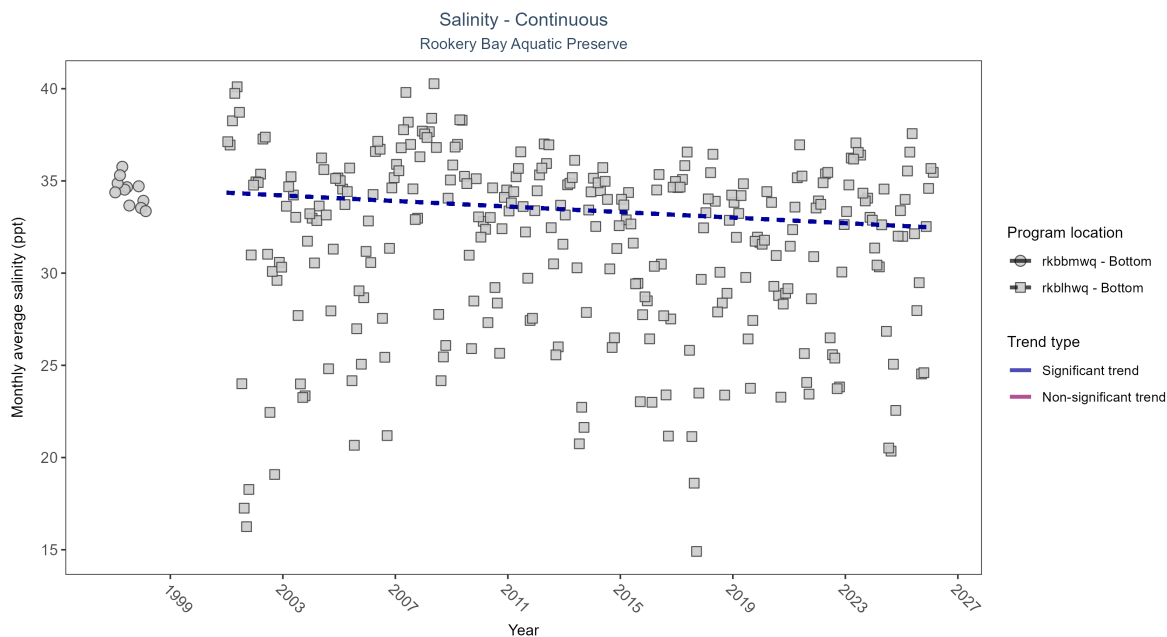


Figure 15: Scatter plot of monthly average salinity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 8: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Salinity

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau   | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|-------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 12256        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 34.5                | -     | -             | -         | -      |
| rkblhwq          | Significantly decreasing trend       | 700367       | 26              | 2001 - 2026      | 33.2                | -0.13 | 34.36         | -0.08     | 0.0023 |

At one program location, monthly average salinity decreased by 0.08 ppt per year. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.



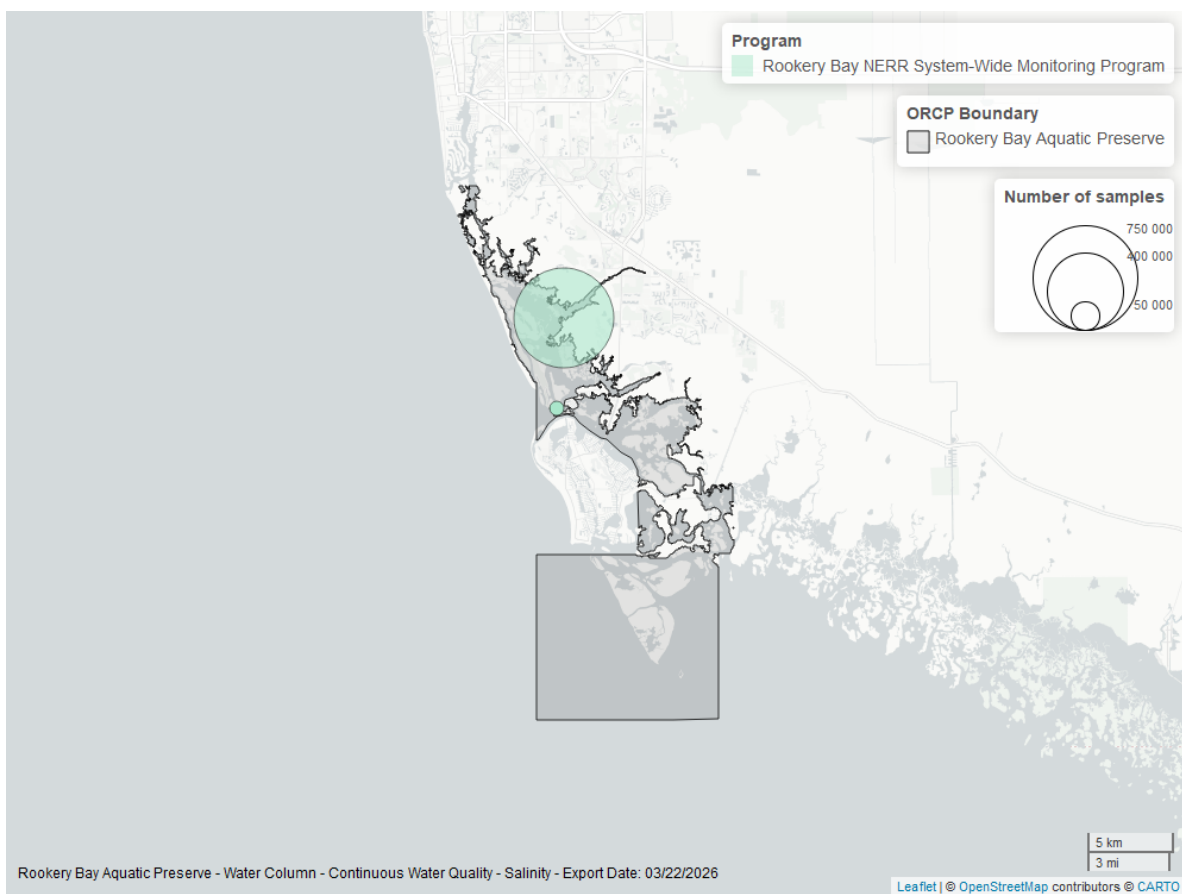


Figure 16: Map showing location of salinity continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Water Temperature - Continuous

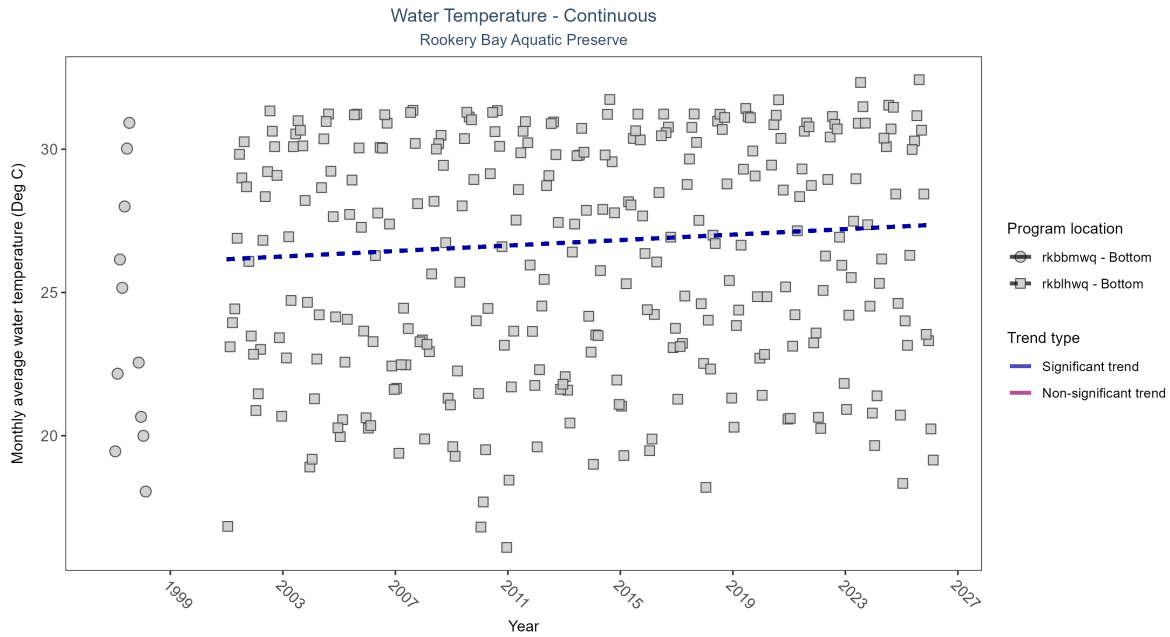


Figure 17: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 9: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Water Temperature

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|---|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 12610        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 23.8                | -    | -             | -         | - |
| rkblhwq          | Significantly increasing trend       | 731519       | 26              | 2001 - 2026      | 26.9                | 0.24 | 26.16         | 0.05      | 0 |

At one program location, monthly average water temperature increased by 0.05°C per year. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

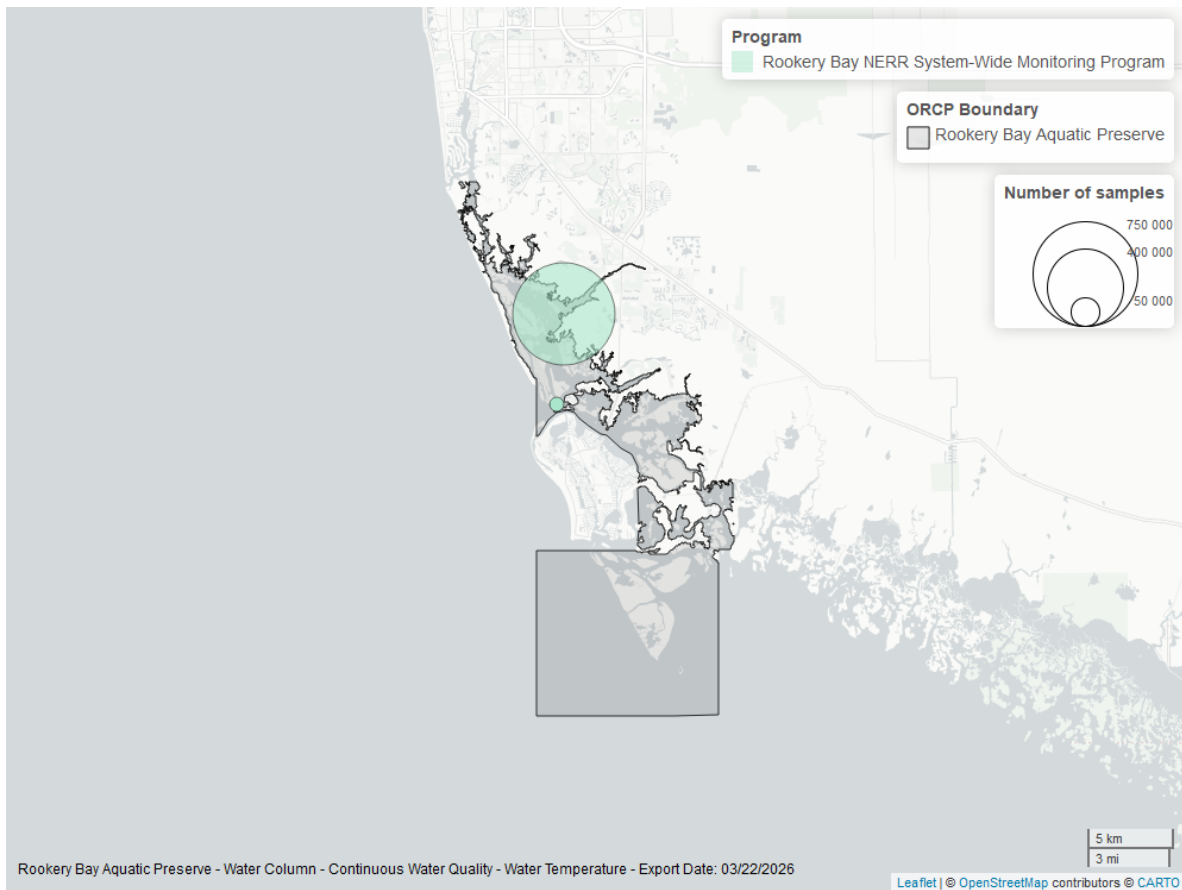


Figure 18: Map showing location of water temperature continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Water Temperature - Discrete

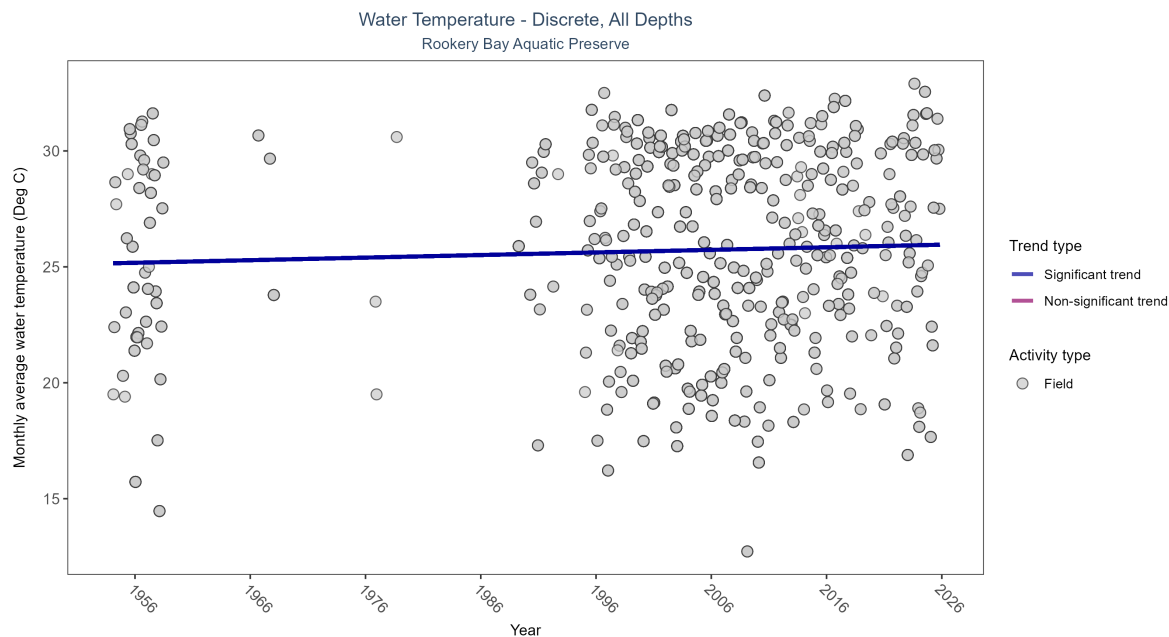


Figure 19: Scatter plot of monthly average water temperature over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only water temperature measurements taken in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 10: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Water Temperature

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau    | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|--------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | Significantly increasing trend | 4571         | 45              | 1954 - 2025      | 26.22               | 0.0837 | 25.15326      | 0.01114   | 0.0137 |

Monthly average water temperature increased by  $0.01^{\circ}\text{C}$  per year.

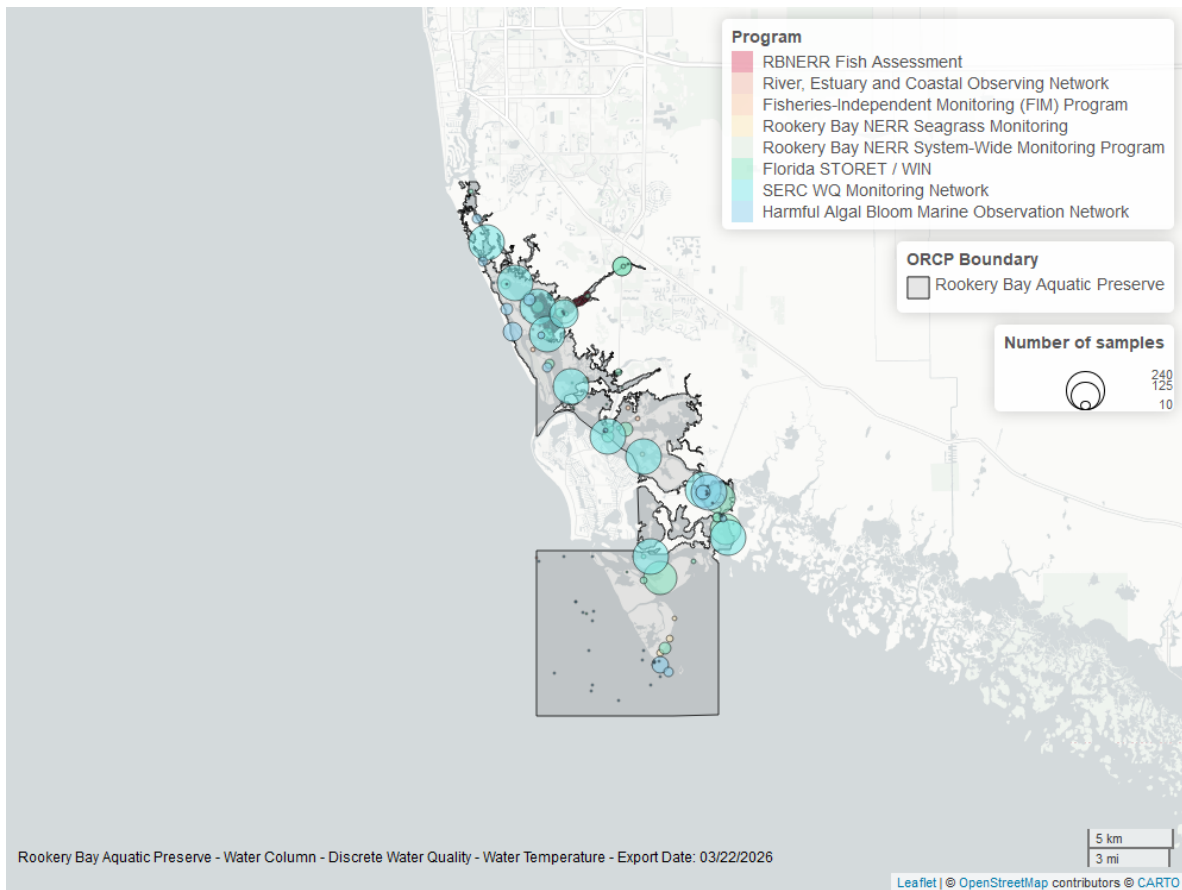


Figure 20: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## pH - Continuous

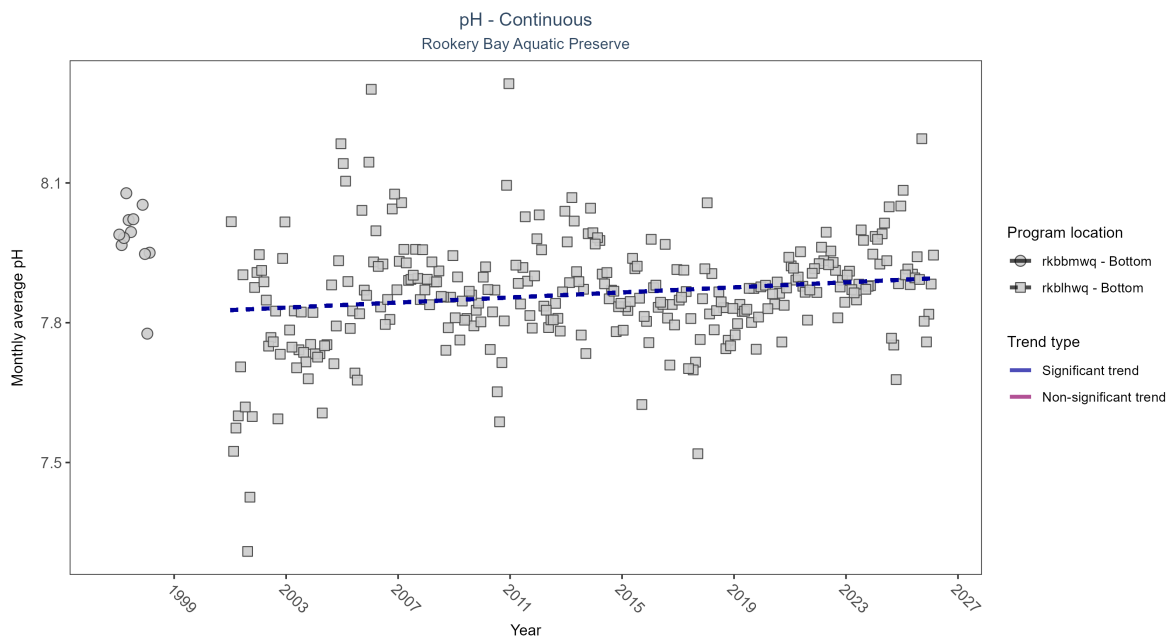


Figure 21: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 11: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - pH

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau  | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P     |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|------|---------------|-----------|-------|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 12610        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 8.0                 | -    | -             | -         | -     |
| rkblhwq          | Significantly increasing trend       | 672354       | 26              | 2001 - 2026      | 7.9                 | 0.15 | 7.83          | 0         | 3e-04 |

At one program location, monthly average pH increased by less than 0.01 pH units per year. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

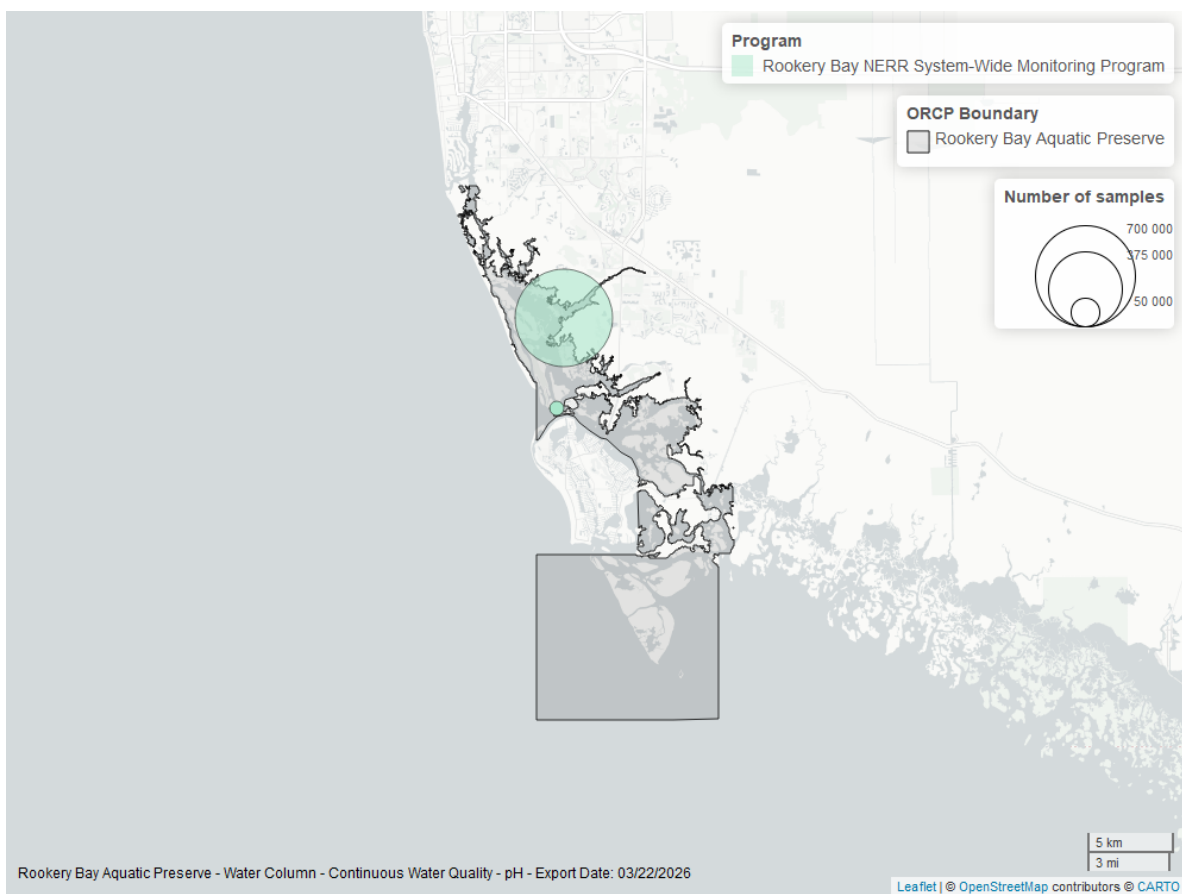


Figure 22: Map showing location of pH continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## pH - Discrete

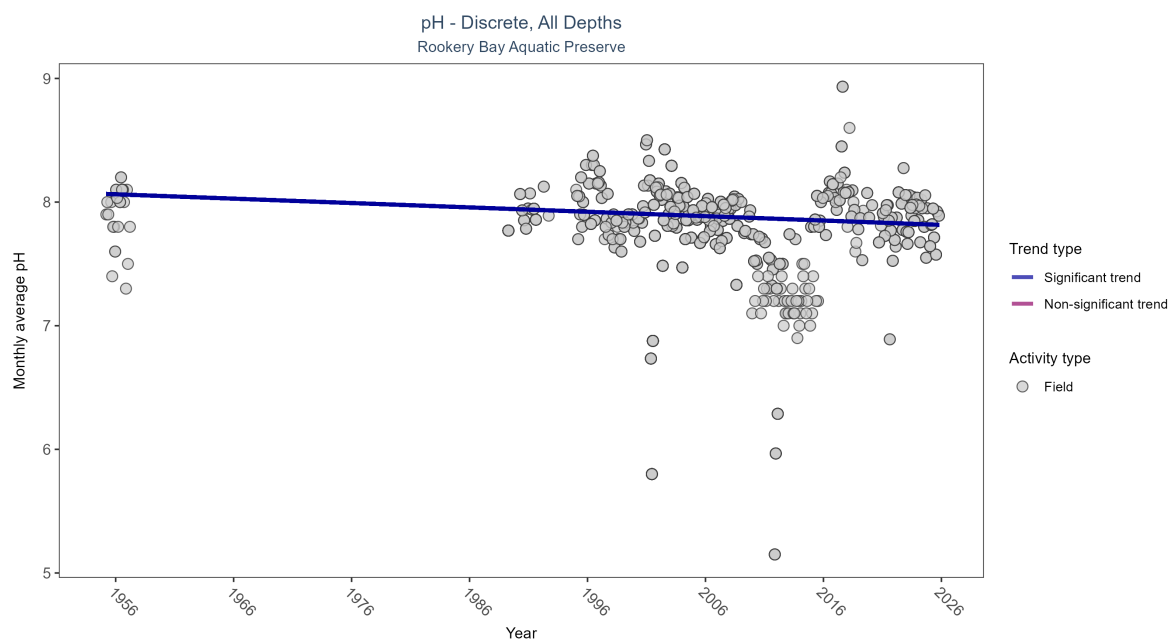


Figure 23: Scatter plot of monthly average pH over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only pH values measured in the field (circles) are included in the plot.

Table 12: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - pH

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau      | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P     |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|----------|---------------|-----------|-------|
| Field         | Significantly decreasing trend | 1887         | 38              | 1955 - 2025      | 7.9                 | -0.13597 | 8.06668       | -0.00354  | 4e-04 |

Monthly average pH decreased by less than 0.01 pH units per year.



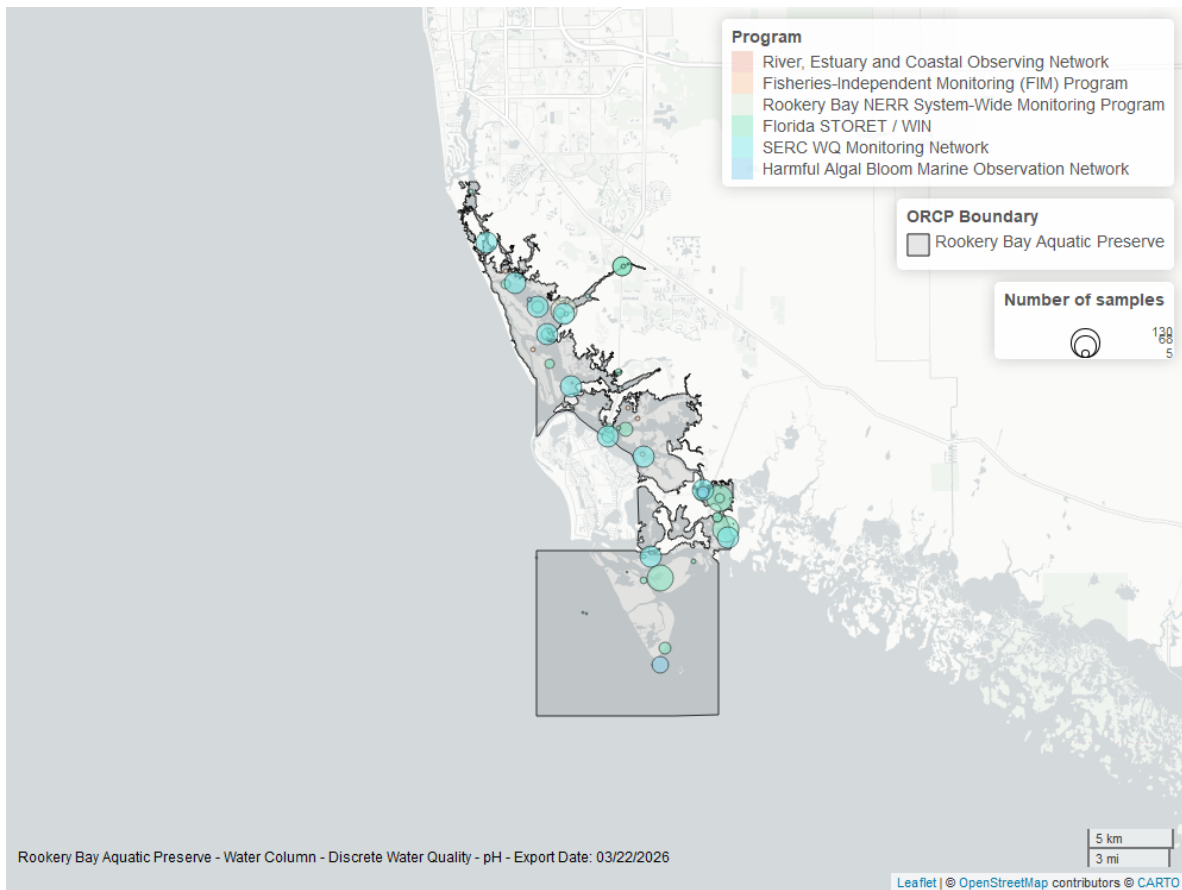


Figure 24: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Specific Conductivity - Continuous

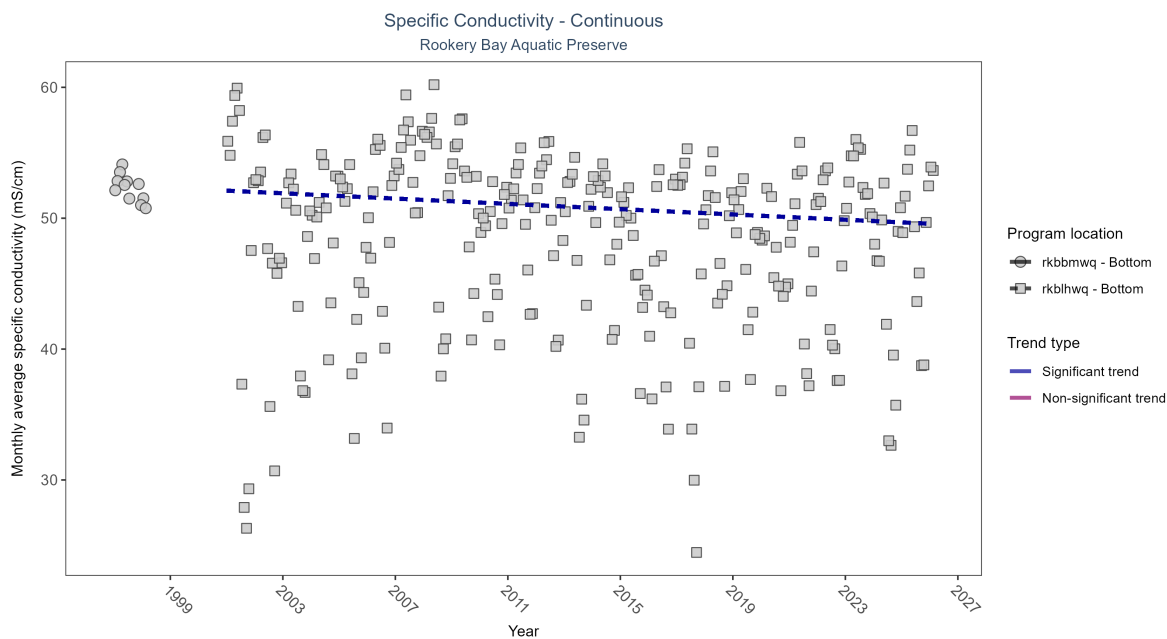


Table 13: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Specific Conductivity

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau   | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P     |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|-------|---------------|-----------|-------|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 12256        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 52.41               | -     | -             | -         | -     |
| rkblhwq          | Significantly decreasing trend       | 700390       | 26              | 2001 - 2026      | 50.59               | -0.12 | 52.11         | -0.1      | 0.003 |

At one program location, monthly average specific conductivity decreased by 0.10 ms/cm per year. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

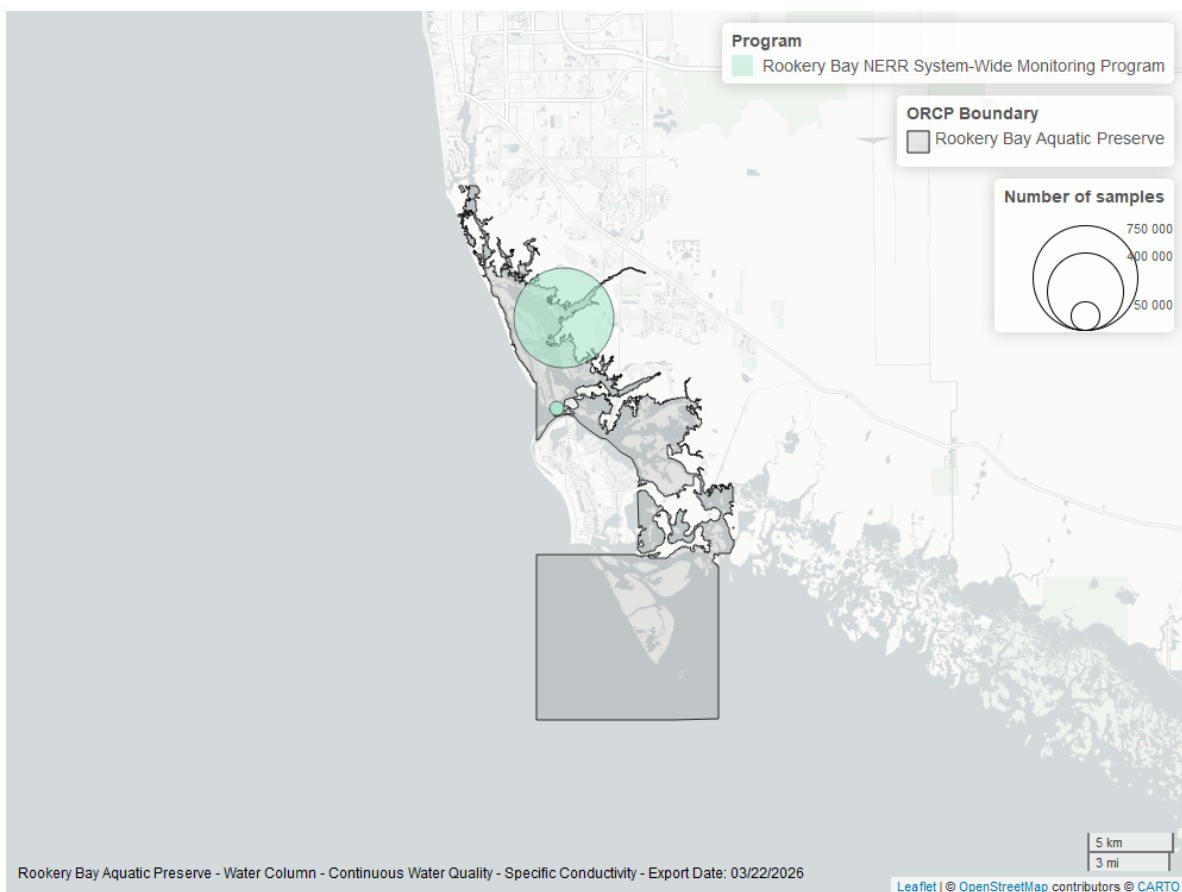


Figure 25: Map showing location of specific conductivity continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

# Water Clarity

## Turbidity - Continuous

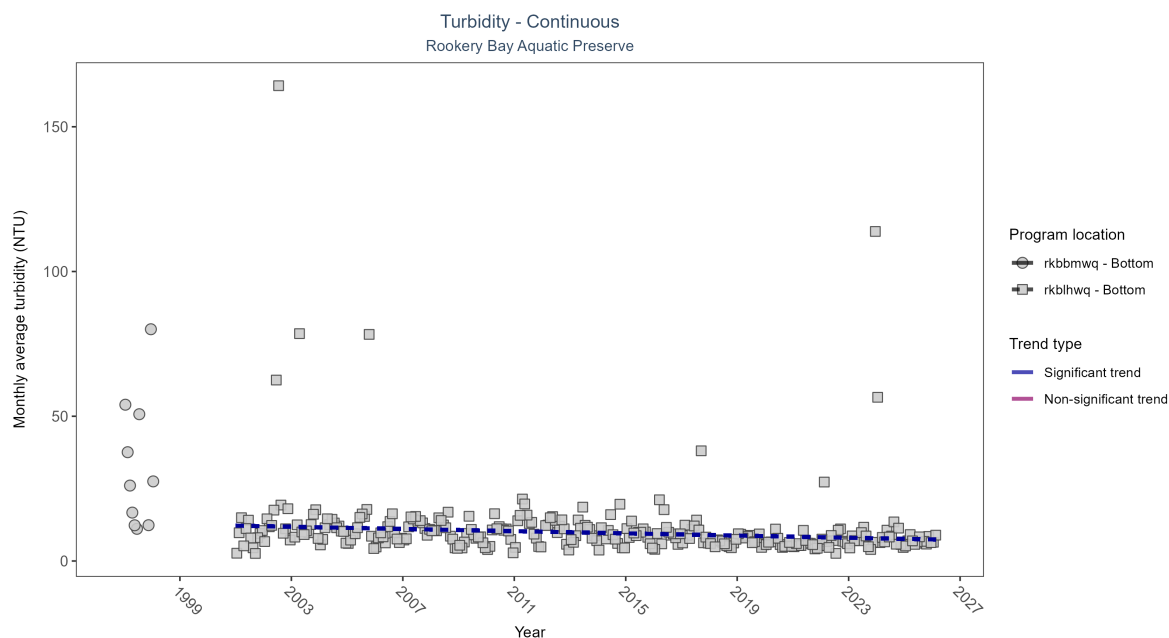


Figure 26: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time at continuously monitored program locations. Each location is analyzed separately, with significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend lines shown for time series that included five or more years of observations.

Table 14: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results - Turbidity

| Program Location | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau   | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|------------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|-------|---------------|-----------|---|
| rkbbmwq          | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 10654        | 2               | 1997 - 1998      | 11                  | -     | -             | -         | - |
| rkblhwq          | Significantly decreasing trend       | 647527       | 26              | 2001 - 2026      | 8                   | -0.28 | 12.22         | -0.19     | 0 |

At one program location, monthly average turbidity decreased by 0.19 NTU per year. There was insufficient data to fit a model for one location.

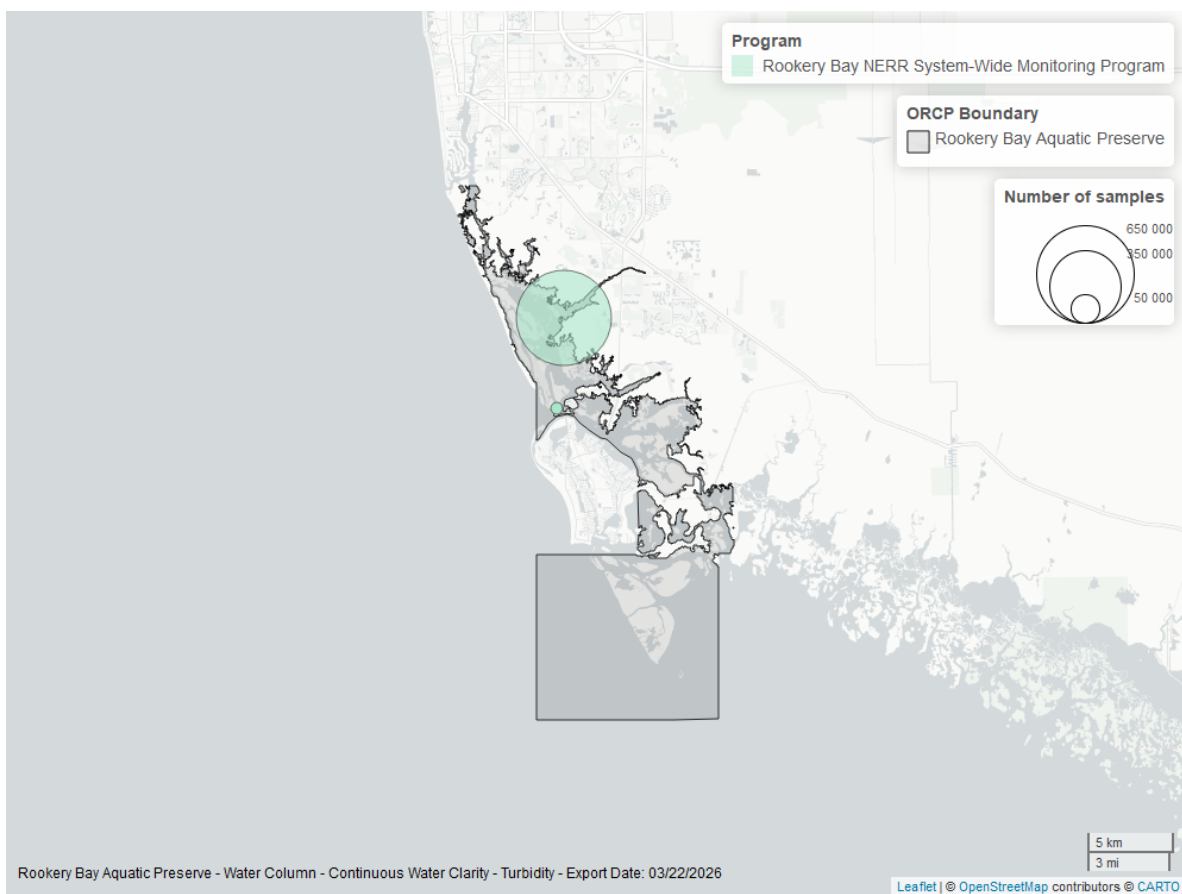


Figure 27: Map showing location of turbidity continuous water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Turbidity - Discrete

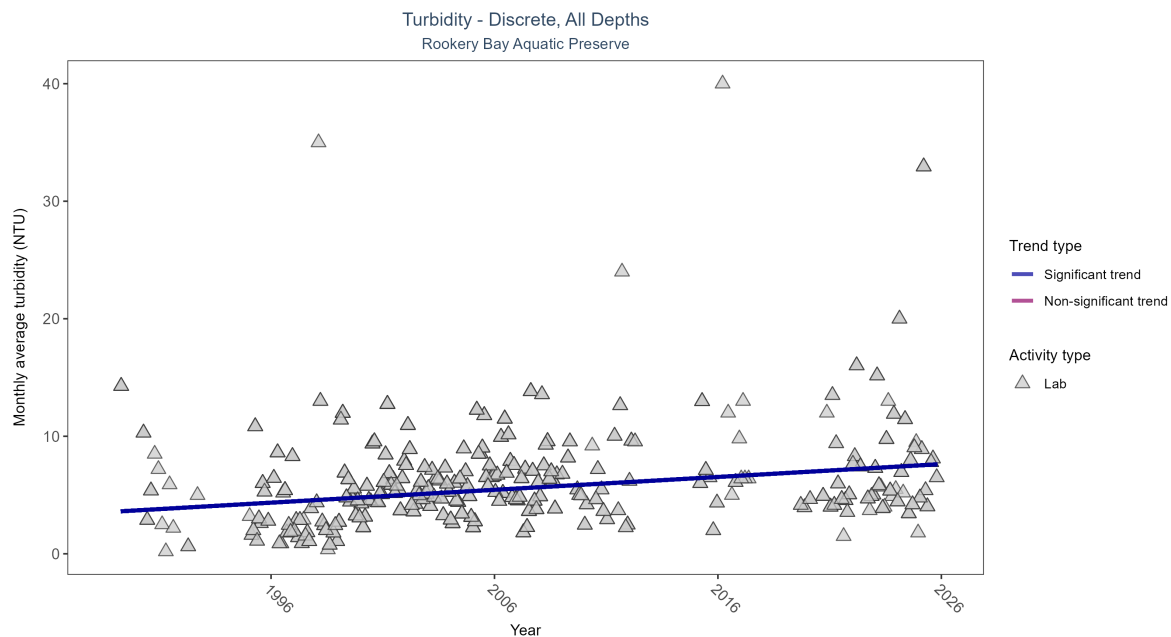


Figure 28: Scatter plot of monthly average turbidity over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only turbidity values measured in the laboratory (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 15: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Turbidity

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|---|
| Lab           | Significantly increasing trend | 1879         | 32              | 1989 - 2025      | 5                   | 0.23872 | 3.58473       | 0.10936   | 0 |

Monthly average turbidity increased by 0.11 NTU per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

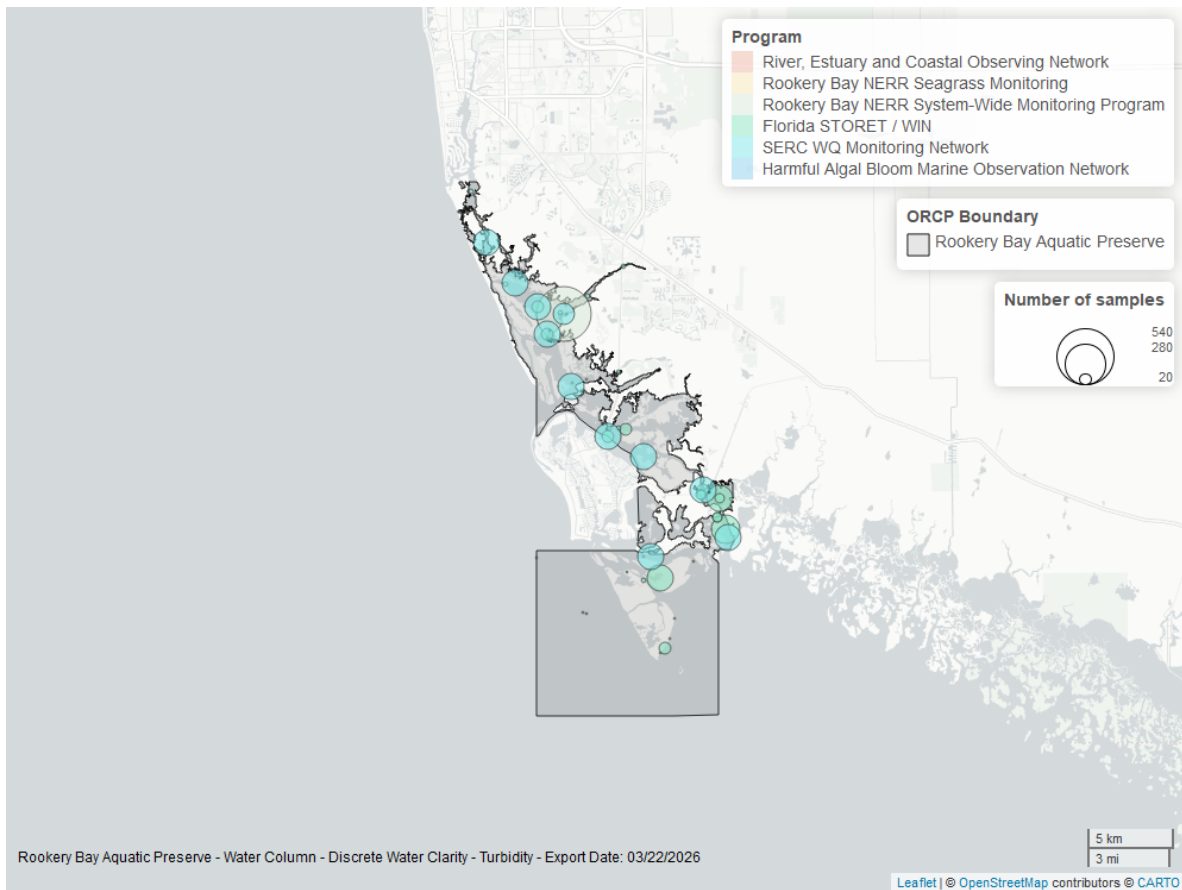


Figure 29: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Total Suspended Solids - Discrete

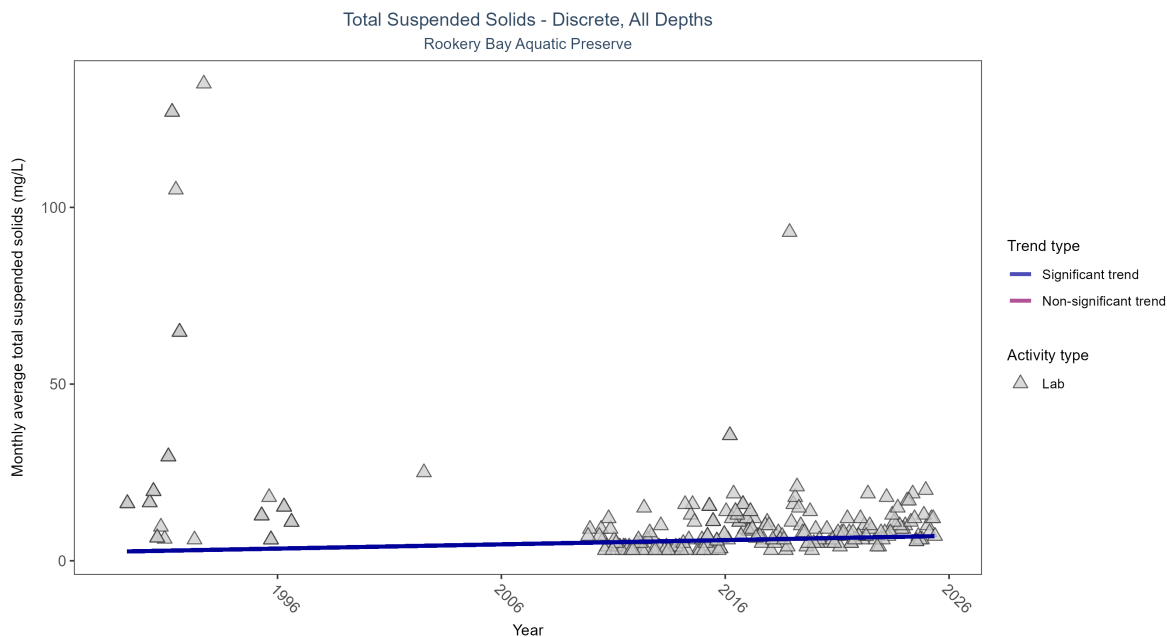


Figure 30: Scatter plot of monthly average total suspended solids (TSS) over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only TSS values obtained from laboratory analyses (triangles) are included in the plot.

Table 16: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Total Suspended Solids

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | Significantly increasing trend | 260          | 24              | 1989 - 2025      | 8                   | 0.13598 | 2.6125        | 0.12      | 0.0239 |

Monthly average total suspended solids increased by 0.12 mg/L per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.



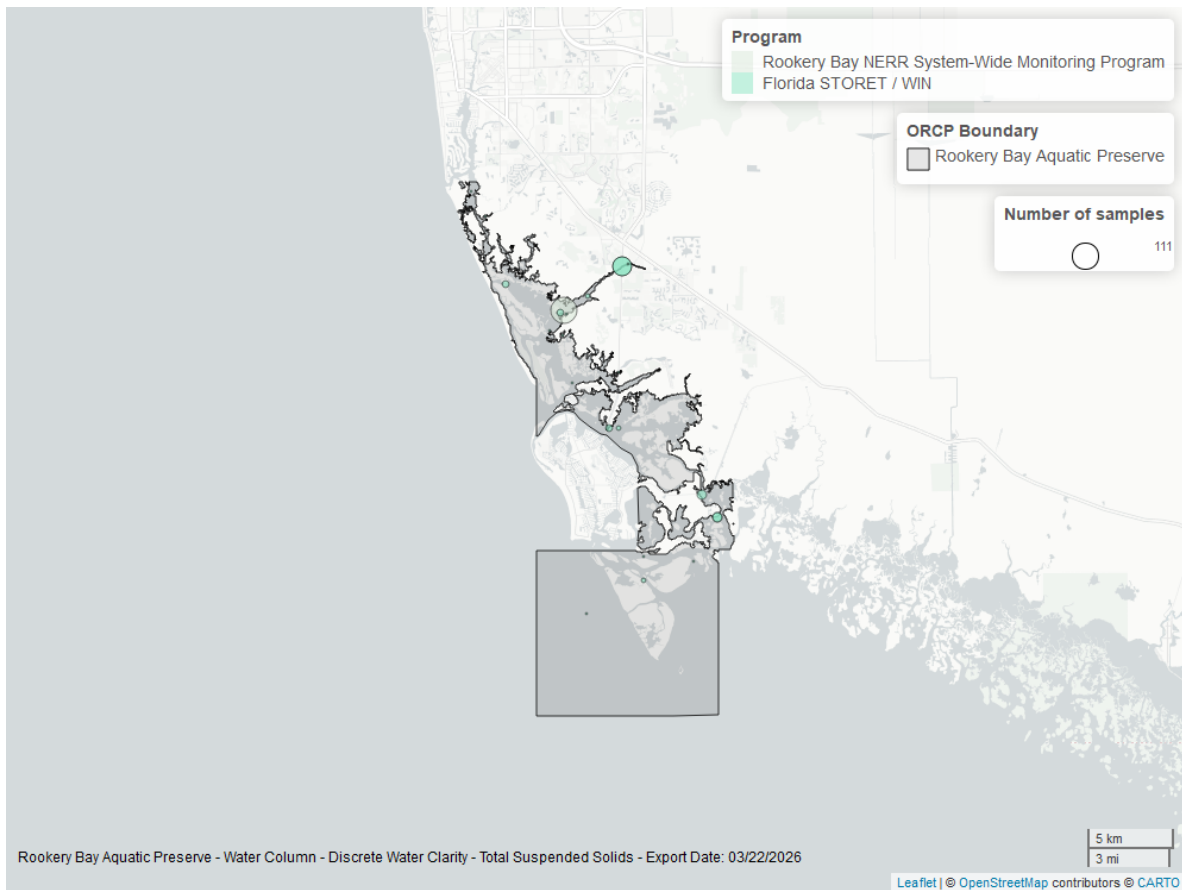


Figure 31: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

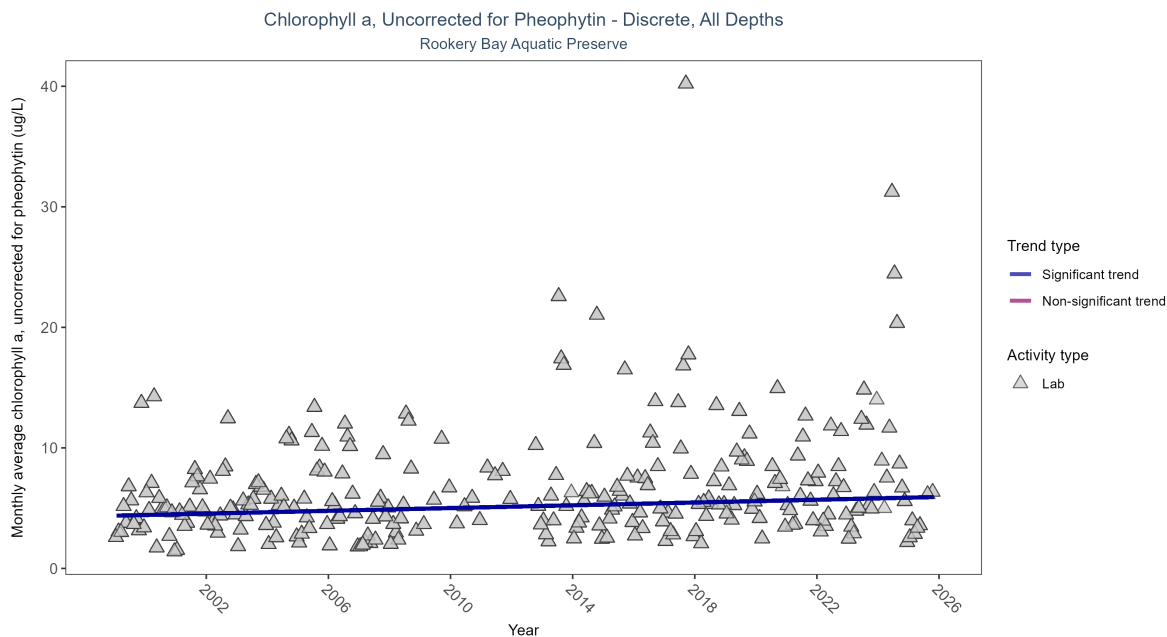


Figure 32: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 17: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Chlorophyll a, Uncorrected for Pheophytin

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend              | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P     |
|---------------|--------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|-------|
| Lab           | Significantly increasing trend | 3290         | 27              | 1999 - 2025      | 5                   | 0.17531 | 4.37536       | 0.05756   | 1e-04 |

Monthly average chlorophyll a, uncorrected for pheophytin, increased by 0.06  $\mu\text{g/L}$  per year, indicating a decrease in water clarity.

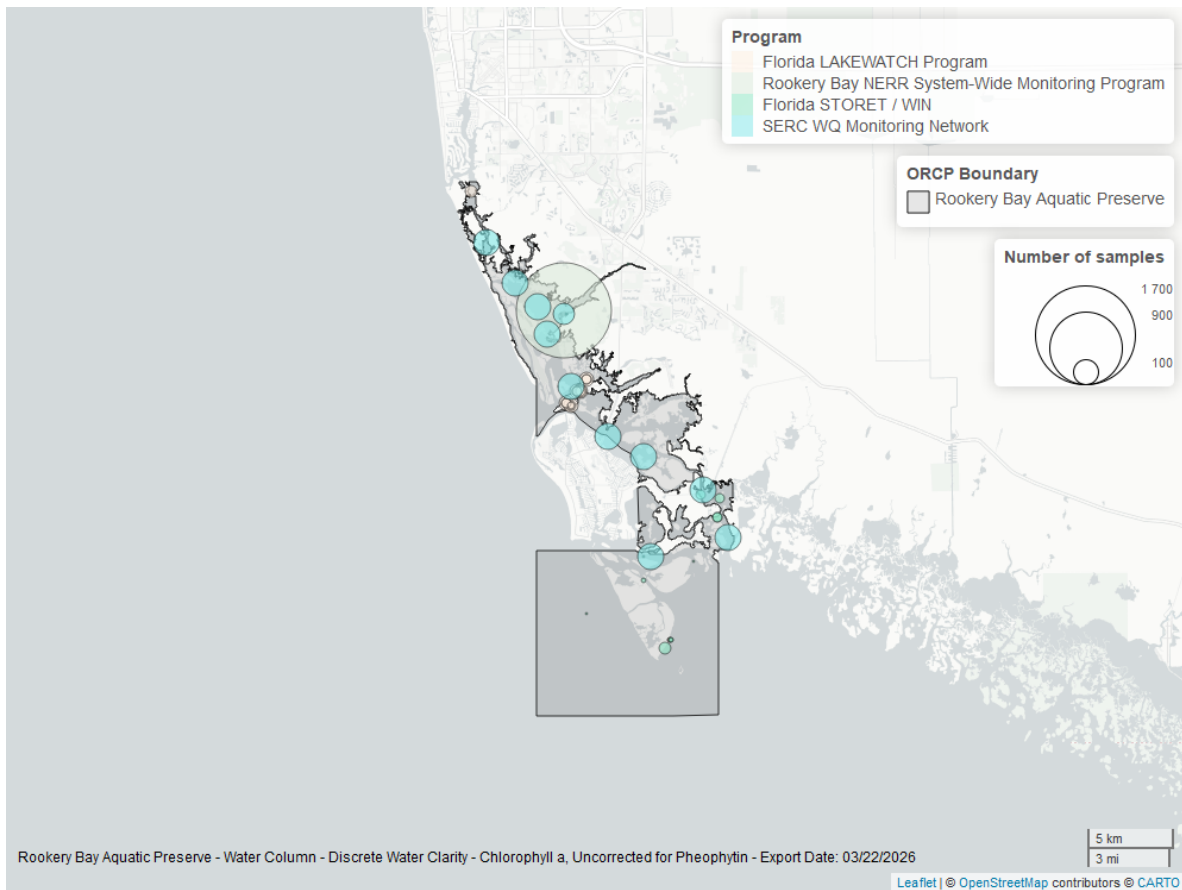


Figure 33: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin - Discrete

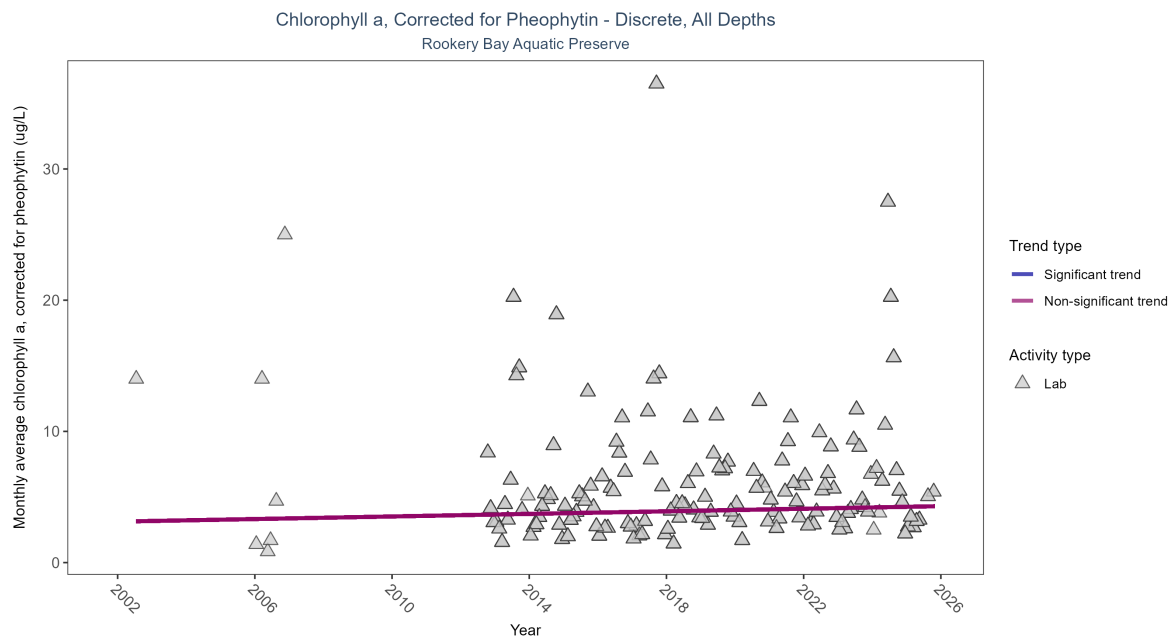


Figure 34: Scatter plot of monthly average levels of chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed chlorophyll a (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 18: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Chlorophyll a, Corrected for Pheophytin

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Lab           | No significant trend | 1713         | 16              | 2002 - 2025      | 4.3                 | 0.09735 | 3.12217       | 0.04914   | 0.1062 |

Chlorophyll a, corrected for pheophytin, showed no detectable trend between 2002 and 2025.

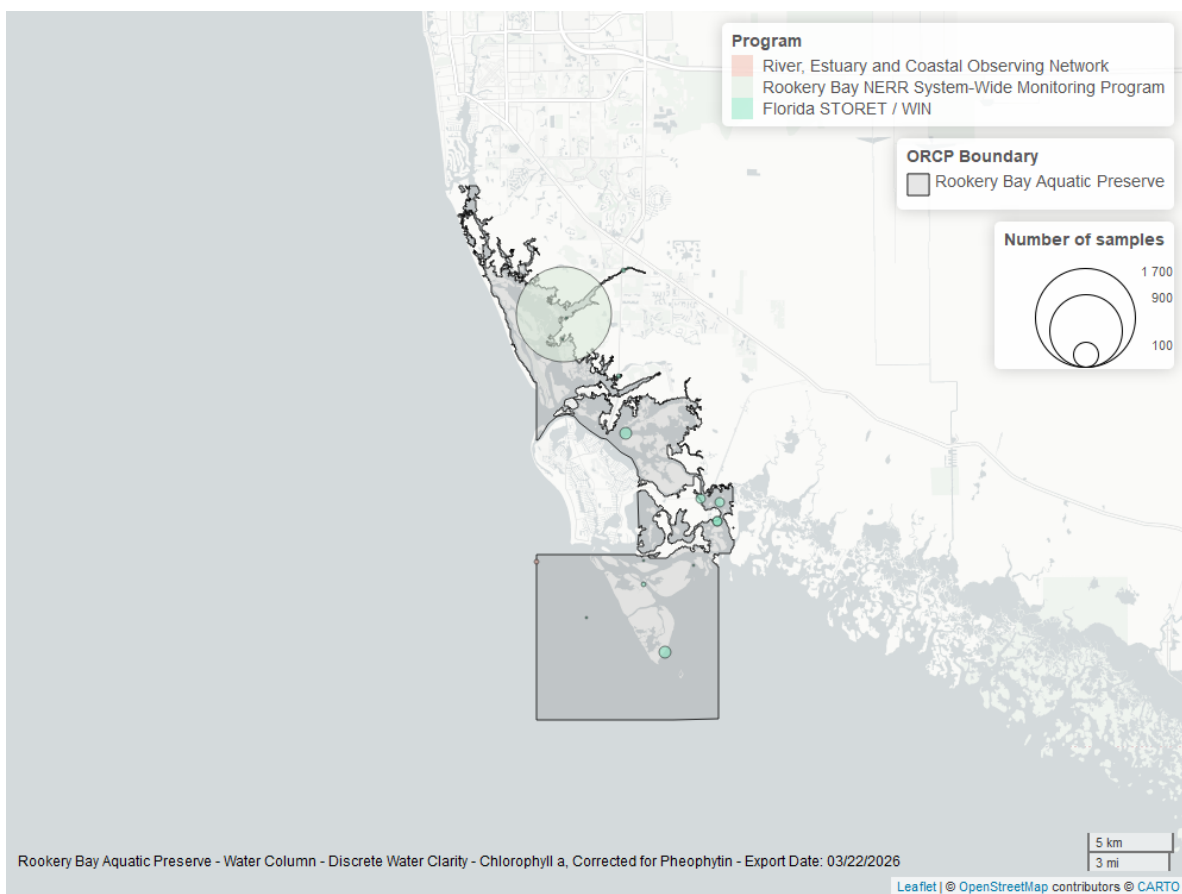


Figure 35: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

## Secchi Depth - Discrete

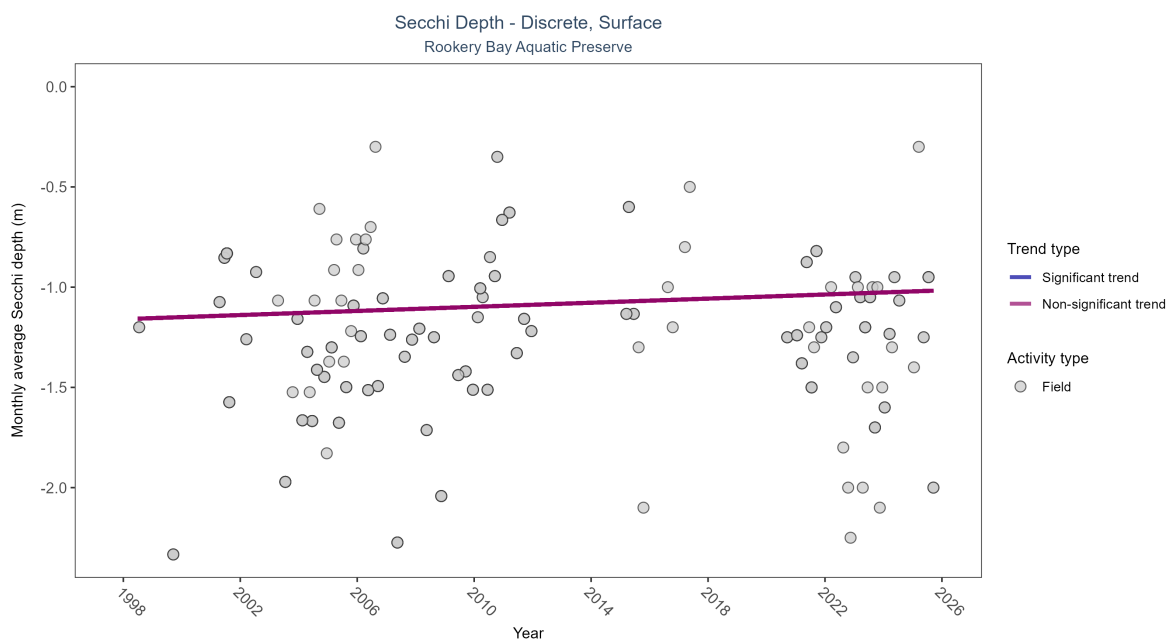


Figure 36: Scatter plot of monthly average Secchi depth over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Secchi depth is only measured in the field (circles).

Table 19: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Secchi Depth

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau     | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P      |
|---------------|----------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|---------|---------------|-----------|--------|
| Field         | No significant trend | 368          | 22              | 1998 - 2025      | -1.2                | 0.06055 | -1.15973      | 0.00513   | 0.3955 |

Secchi depth showed no detectable trend between 1998 and 2025.

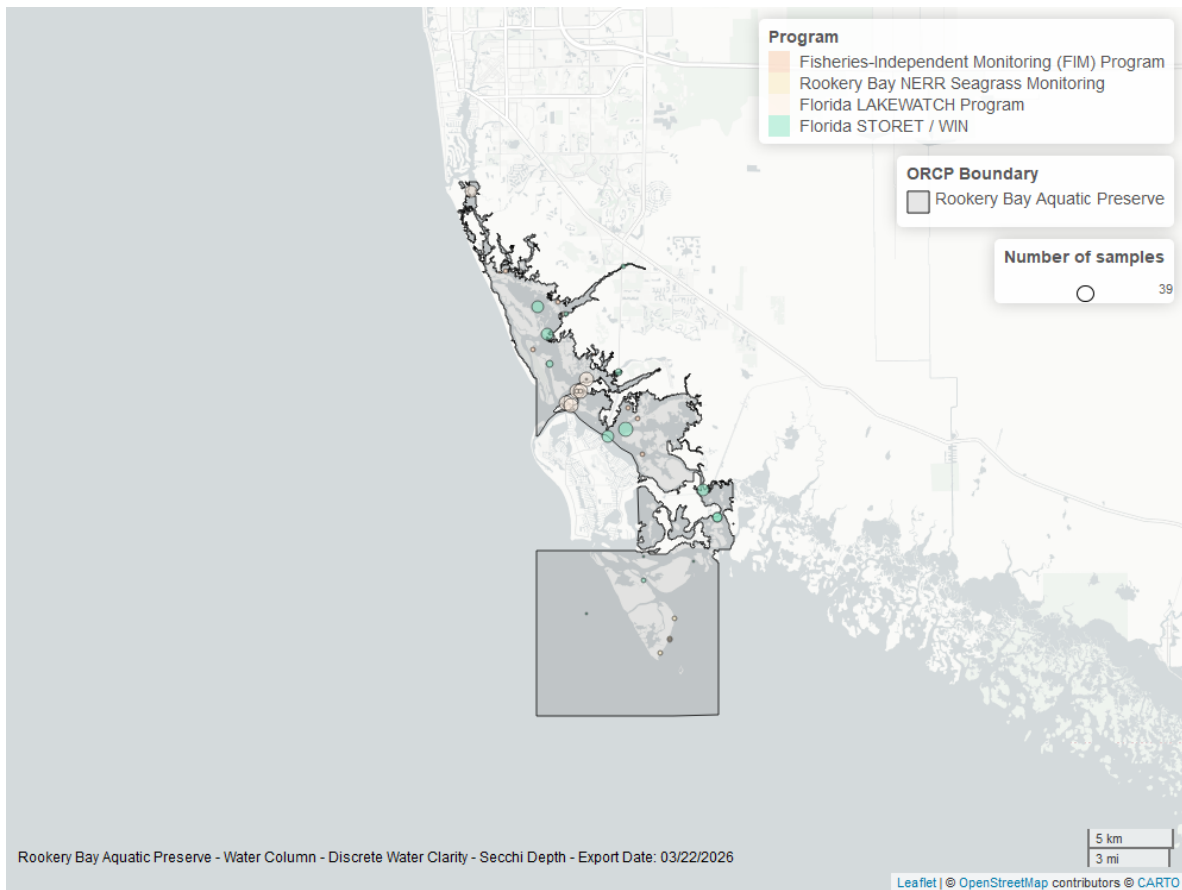


Figure 37: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.

Colored Dissolved Organic Matter - Discrete

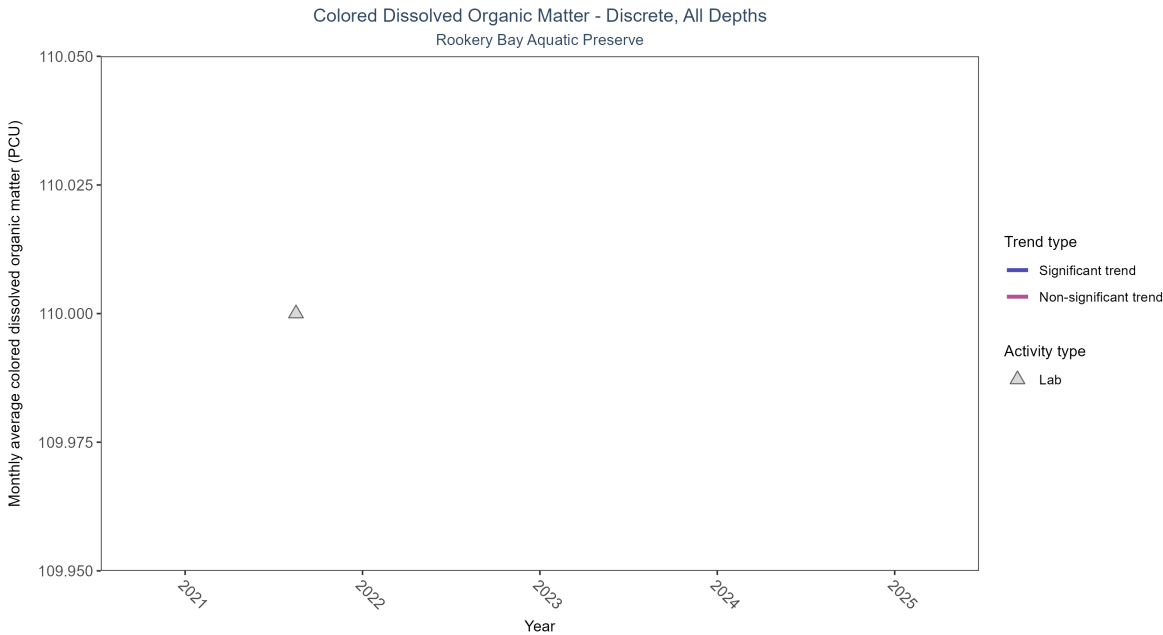


Figure 38: Scatter plot of monthly average colored dissolved organic matter (CDOM) over time. If the time series included ten or more years of discrete observations, a significant (blue) or non-significant (magenta) trend line is also shown. Only laboratory-analyzed CDOM (triangles) is included in the plot.

Table 20: Seasonal Kendall-Tau Results for - Colored Dissolved Organic Matter

| Activity Type | Statistical Trend                    | Sample Count | Years with Data | Period of Record | Median Result Value | Tau | Sen Intercept | Sen Slope | P |
|---------------|--------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|---------------------|-----|---------------|-----------|---|
| Lab           | Insufficient data to calculate trend | 1            | 1               | 2021 - 2021      | 110                 | -   | -             | -         | - |

There was insufficient data to fit a model for colored dissolved organic matter.



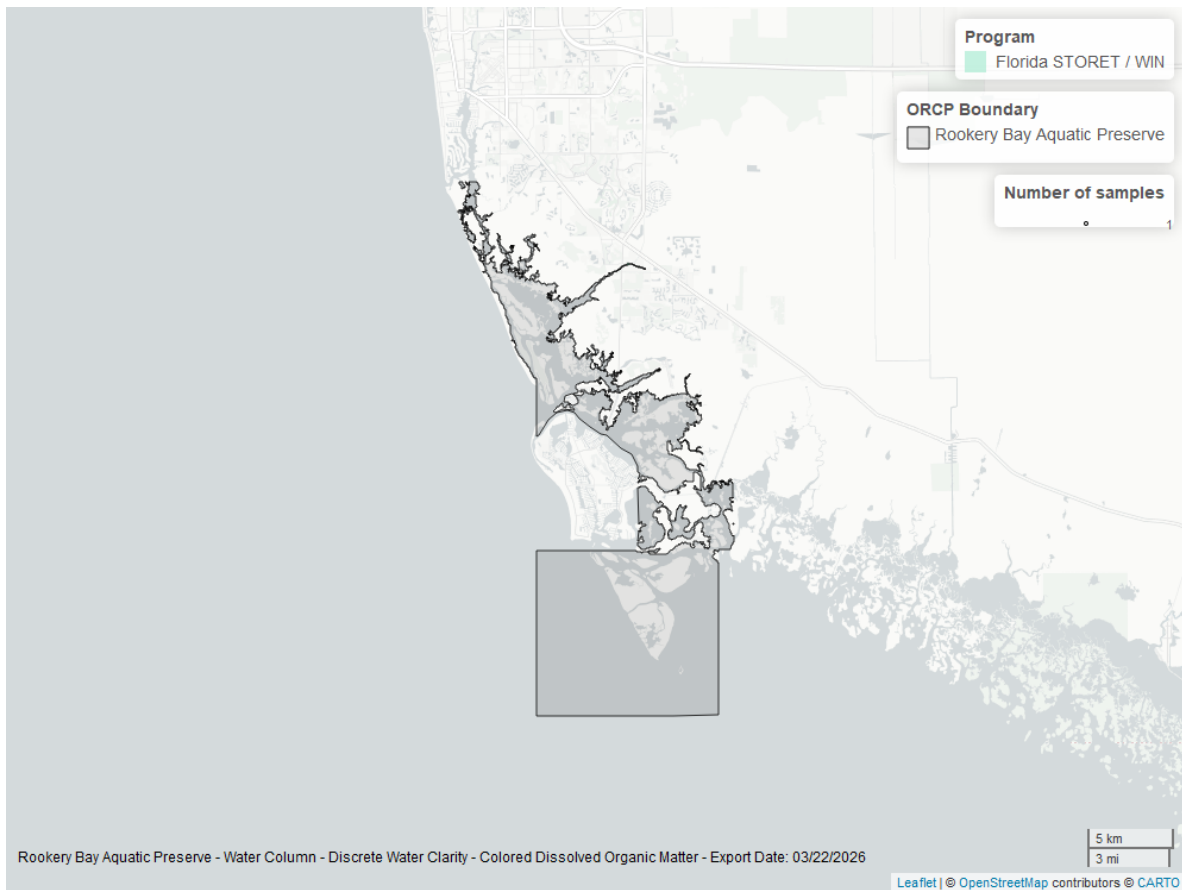


Figure 39: Map showing location of discrete water quality sampling locations within the boundaries of *Rookery Bay Aquatic Preserve*. The bubble size on the maps above reflect the amount of data available at each sampling site.